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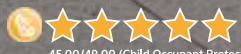



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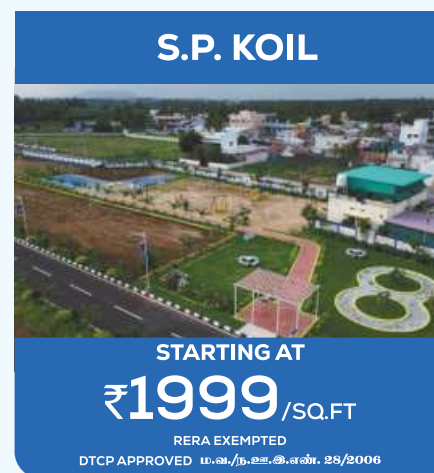


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RSS DEFAMATION CASE

Special court rejects Priyank's contention

SOUTH » PAGE 7

FIFA WORLD CUP

Kane powers England into last 16

SPORT » PAGE 15





'CATASTROPHIC IMPACT'

UN panel flags risk of unchecked AI progress

WORLD » PAGE 14

KEY OPPORTUNITY

Building India's coal chemistry capability

Refinery resilience amid crisis points to its future

EDITORIAL » PAGE 8



'VIJAY' ROAD MAP

Army chief unveils transformation vision

NEWS » PAGE 10

NEARBY



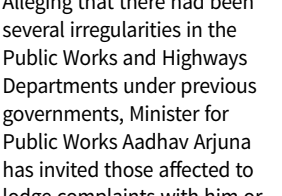
TVK, partners discuss steps to formalise alliance

CHENNAI



TVK president and Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay held discussions with post-poll partners on formalising an alliance. » PAGE 6

CHENNAI



Alleging that there had been several irregularities in the Public Works and Highways Departments under previous governments, Minister for Public Works Aadhav Arjuna has invited those affected to lodge complaints with him or the DVAC. » PAGE 6

METROPLUS » 4 PAGES

Commercial LPG prices reduced by ₹183 per refill

The first price cut this year follows a hike of ₹1,345 in four tranches; no respite for domestic users; ATF prices reduced by ₹5 per litre; Nayara Energy cuts petrol price by ₹5 and diesel by ₹3 per litre

Saptaparno Ghosh
NEW DELHI

In an indication of an improvement in the supply of liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) with the four-month West Asia conflict at a probable end, public sector oil marketing companies (OMCs) on Wednesday cut the prices of commercial LPG cylinders by ₹183.5 and those of the 5-kg free-trade LPG (FTL) cylinders by ₹13.

This was the first reduction in commercial LPG price in 2026 after the rates were hiked by ₹1,345 a refill in four tranches since March 7 and comes a week after the government lifted supply restrictions on commercial LPG.

However, there was no immediate relief for households as the price of domestic LPG, which was increased in two tranches by almost ₹90, remains unchanged.

The OMCs also cut the price of aviation turbine fuel for domestic carriers by ₹5 a litre.

Separately, the privately

Price revision

Oil marketing companies cut commercial LPG cylinder refill prices by up to ₹183, while domestic LPG prices remained unchanged amid easing supply concerns

Month	Delhi	Chennai
March 7, 2026	₹1,883	₹2,043.5
April 1, 2026	₹2,078.5	₹2,246.5
June 1, 2026	₹3,113.5	₹3,283
July 1, 2026	₹2,930	₹3,106

The cut follows four tranches of hikes since March 7 that had raised commercial LPG prices by a cumulative ₹1,345 per 19-kg cylinder refill



owned OMC Nayara Energy, which operates more than 7,000 pumps across the country, reduced the price of petrol and diesel by ₹5 and ₹3 per litre, respectively. It had hiked fuel prices by the same amount at the peak of the conflict on March 26.

Reduced prices

After Wednesday's revision, the price of a 19-kg LPG cylinder in Delhi, which serves as a benchmark for prices in the country, was down by ₹183.5 to ₹2,930; in Mumbai it was ₹2,885.5 (down ₹182), in Kolkata ₹3081.5 (down ₹174), and in Chennai ₹3,106 (down ₹177).

The *Chhotu* FTL cylinder refills, primarily catering to migrant workers, are now available at ₹808.5 in Delhi.

Usually, non-domestic or commercial LPG accounts for about 13% of overall LPG sales by public sector OMCs.

According to the latest provisional data of the Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell for June 2026, the overall consumption of

LPG, domestic and commercial combined, declined 16.7% from the comparable period last year. This coincides with the commercial LPG supply restrictions in place, as well as the higher interim booking timelines for LPG.

Close monitoring

Speaking to *The Hindu*, Prashant Vashisht, senior vice-president and co-group head of corporate sector ratings at ICRA, said the opening of the Strait of Hormuz should help ease supplies of LPG provided there are no more flare-ups. He added that price pressures could alleviate further with the Gulf re-emerging as a procurement avenue.

"[Before the conflict], we were heavily reliant on the Gulf for our LPG requirements. Amid the conflict, increased supplies came from the U.S. and Australia, which are a bit far, and meant longer transit," he said.

RELIEF AND DEMAND
» PAGE 12

GST revenues up 14% in June amid dependence on imports

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

The government's Goods and Services Tax (GST) revenue grew 13.9% to ₹1.95 lakh crore in June 2026 compared with the corresponding period in 2025, the highest year-on-year growth rate in 13 months. However, the bulk of this growth came from imports, with the tax collected from domestic transactions growing far slower.

The data shows that GST revenue from domestic transactions grew 6.5% to about ₹1.35 lakh crore in June 2026. This made up 69% of the total GST revenue earned that month, down from the 74% share it held in June last year.

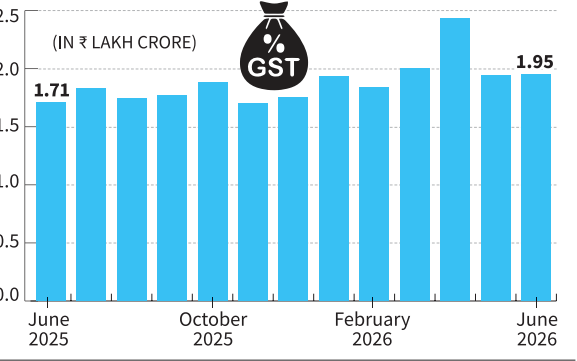
Revenue from imports, on the other hand, grew nearly 35% in June 2026 to ₹6 lakh crore.

This marks the 16th consecutive month in which GST revenues from imports have grown in double digits, and the 10th straight month in which their growth has exceeded the growth in revenues from domestic transactions.

Tax experts are divided on the cause for this sharp rise in revenues from imports, but they agree that it

Consistent progress

The 13.9% growth in June 2026 is the highest y-o-y rise in 13 months. The graph shows GST revenue in the last 1-year period



is something the government must keep an eye on.

Further, as GST marked nine years of implementation on Wednesday, tax experts point to several aspects – such as input tax credits, dispute resolution, multiple registrations, and the inverted duty structure – as issues that still need to be addressed. However, they do acknowledge that the system has been steadily improving over the years.

According to Saurabh Agarwal, tax partner at EY India, a possible reason could be that India is importing what it should be manufacturing.

"The rising share of collections from imports war-

rants closer structural analysis," Mr. Agarwal said. He pointed out that one way to mitigate this reliance is to redeploy unutilised outlays from the production linked incentive schemes to strategically attract and scale high-value manufacturing within India.

Mahesh Jaising, partner and indirect tax leader at Deloitte India, largely echoed these views, saying that the growth in import revenues suggests an increase in the import of raw materials and intermediate goods, which reflects sustained manufacturing activity.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 10

VB-G RAM G to offer minimum ₹300 a day

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Centre has fixed a floor wage of ₹300 per day under the Viksit Bharat-Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) (VB-G RAM G) Act, 2025, which came into effect on Tuesday replacing the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA), 2005.

The 21 States and Union Territories which paid less than ₹300 per day under the MGNREGA have had their wage rates increased to this level, while States already paying above ₹300 saw more minimal hikes.

Four major Hindi-belt States saw significant wage

increases – ₹48 in Uttar Pradesh, ₹45 in Bihar, ₹39 in Madhya Pradesh, and ₹19 in Rajasthan – compared with the last MGNREGA rates set in 2025-26. Haryana (₹409), Goa (₹406) and Kerala (₹401) are the only States with wage rates above ₹400. Barring the U.T. of Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu, where wages remain unchanged from the MGNREGA levels, Telangana recorded the lowest increase of just ₹1, with wages rising 0.33% from ₹307 to ₹308.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 10
DATA POINT
» PAGE 9

Monsoon alert



Flood threat: Dense clouds hover over Mandi town and the Beas river in Himachal Pradesh on Wednesday amid an orange alert issued for the next two days. At least four people were killed in rain-related incidents in the hill State during heavy monsoon rain. ANI

Three held for bid to bribe TVK MLA to vote against Speaker

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Three men have been arrested for attempting to bribe a TVK MLA to vote against Assembly Speaker J.C.D. Prabhakar in a no-confidence motion during the next Assembly session.

A senior official of the Greater Chennai Police said Uthangarai MLA N. Elaiyaraja had lodged a complaint with the City Police Commissioner a few days ago. The complainant said a man named Thirunavukkarasu had contacted him, claiming that he was running an opinion polling firm called Indian Political Democratic Strategies (IPDS), and was reaching out at the behest of a major political party to arrange an in-person meeting. Mr. Elaiyaraja, however, disconnected the call, citing other engagements.

Thirunavukkarasu contacted him again, and claimed that a no-confidence motion was being brought against the Speaker. He asked Mr. Elaiyaraja to act in a specified manner during the vote on the motion, and promised a reward of up to ₹35 crore.

Refusing to do so, Mr. Elaiyaraja told the caller not to contact him again. Thirunavukkarasu then threatened Mr. Elaiyaraja with dire consequences if he disclosed the conversation to anyone.

Consequently, the MLA lodged a complaint with



Thirunavukkarasu, one of the three men arrested for trying to bribe the Uthangarai MLA.

the City Police Commissioner on June 29, and sought legal action against Thirunavukkarasu. Based on the complaint, the Triplicane police filed a case and arrested Thirunavukkarasu of Arumbakkam, Naresh of Tiruchi, and Thiagarajan of Medavakkam.

Further inquiries revealed that V. Ashok Kumar, the brother of Coimbatore South MLA and former DMK Minister V. Senthilbalaji, had met Naresh in Chennai.

Meanwhile, Minister for Energy Resources and Law R. Nirmalkumar alleged that DMK president M.K. Stalin and Leader of the Opposition Udhayanidhi Stalin had entrusted Mr. Senthilbalaji with the task of "luring" TVK MLAs by offering them up to ₹50 crore with the intention of toppling the government.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 6

Centre tells WhatsApp to put username update on hold

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Centre has sent a notice to WhatsApp over its new username feature, asking the platform to put the update on hold.

A senior official said on Wednesday that the government is worried about the potential for spam with the new feature.

FULL REPORT ON
» PAGE 12

U.S. stand dents World Bank's climate finance targets

Jacob Koshy
NEW DELHI

Following disapproval from the U.S. administration, the World Bank Group (WBG) has indicated that it would do away with its funding target for climate-centric projects.

"We will complete our shift from inputs to outcomes to maximise development impact. We will retire the 45% climate co-benefits target and the 35% target in the Climate Change Action Plan [CCAP]. We have done significant work in answering client demand and needs,"

the World Bank said in its June 29 statement on its CCAP. Launched in 2020 and over a five-year period ending 2026, the CCAP mandated the WBG to allocate 35% of its total financing for projects that reduced emissions or helped communities adapt to climate change. The goal was increased to 45% in 2023.

The latest announcement by the World Bank may impact projects in developing countries. In India, the World Bank's climate-focused projects include electrified freight rail and inland waterways to cut transport emissions;



Policy shift: World Bank's climate-focused projects in India include those aimed at cutting transport emissions. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

forest restoration and biodiversity conservation in Madhya Pradesh and Meghalaya; climate-resilient agriculture for smallholders; rehabilitation of ageing large dams; com-

munity-led groundwater management under Atal Bhujal Yojana; mangrove restoration along both coasts; flood forecasting and embankment strengthening in Bihar's Kosi ba-

sin; solar parks and rooftop solar systems; green hydrogen for hard-to-abate industries; battery storage paired with renewables in Chhattisgarh; Kerala's post-2018-flood resilience overhaul; and the "One Health" livestock disease programme guarding against zoonotic spillover.

The Hindu has reached out to the World Bank spokesperson, asking whether the development would impact India-based projects. The spokesperson has not responded so far.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 10

INBRIEF



R. RAVINDRAN

Book on friendship in the age of AI launched at Kilpauk

A book examining friendship and well-being among young people in the age of Artificial Intelligence was launched in Chennai on Wednesday at a private school in Kilpauk. Titled *Friendship as Well-being in the AI Era: New Models of Youth Accompaniment*, the book was authored by Fr. John Alexander SDB. It was released by Fr. Felix Raj, Vice-Chancellor of St. Xavier's University, Kolkata, with the first copy presented to Antoon Vandevelde, Professor Emeritus, University of Leuven, Belgium, and Sashi Kumar, Chairman of the Asian College of Journalism. A discussion between the author of the book and Mr. Sashi Kumar was moderated by Joshua Madan, Chief Executive Officer of Covenant Group. The discussion stressed the importance of nurturing friendships, and also verifying information.



B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

Toll in ammonia gas leak at Tiruvallur firm rises to 17

The death toll in the ammonia gas leak at a seafood processing and export facility in Tiruvallur district increased to 17, following the death of a woman from Odisha on Tuesday. Of the 83 persons who were affected in the ammonia gas leak that occurred on June 21, 15 women are still hospitalised.

Timings

CHENNAI

THURSDAY, JUL. 02

RISE

05:47

SET

18:39

RISE

20:37

SET

07:32

FRIDAY, JUL. 03

RISE

05:47

SET

18:40

RISE

21:17

SET

08:22

SATURDAY, JUL. 04

RISE

05:48

SET

18:40

RISE

21:55

SET

09:12

Chennai Weather

max

min

Tiruvallur

40

26

Chennai Airport

39

28

Chennai City

38

28

Chennai Airport Today
36°C The weather will be very warm and uneasy. The night also will be uneasy. A spell of light rain and thundershowers may occur.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow
37°C The morning will be comfortable. The day will be very warm and uneasy. The night also will be uneasy. Mostly dry weather to prevail.

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THE HINDU
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Bars at Tasmac outlets down shutters as licence expires

A source in Tasmac says that the closure of bars can lead to ₹400-crore loss per month. Minister K. Vignesh says discussions on whether to extend the licences or invite tenders are under way

Sangeetha Kandavel
CHENNAI

Bars attached to liquor retail outlets across Tamil Nadu have downed their shutters after their licences expired on June 30, 2026, bringing operations to a halt, until further orders from the State government.

The Tamil Nadu State Marketing Corporation Limited (Tasmac) has around 2,320 bars attached to its retail liquor outlets. According to K. Vignesh, Minister for Prohibition and Excise, discussions are underway on whether to ex-



Tasmac has around 2,320 bars attached to its retail liquor outlets. FILE PHOTO

tend the existing licences or invite fresh tenders. "The matter has to be placed before the board, which will take a decision,"

he said. A source in Tasmac said that a board meeting is expected to happen on Thursday. The source added that the closure of bars could lead to a loss of ₹400 crore per month. "We were told that fresh tenders will be floated, and the government is planning to introduce several changes in the new tender documents," the source added.

Employees at liquor outlets have expressed concerns that the closure of bars could lead to people consuming alcohol outside the shops. "Adequate measures should be put in place to ensure that people

do not create any nuisance outside the shops," a salesman in the Chennai region said.

The licences of the operators running the bars were issued in January 2024 and were originally due to expire in January 2026. They were extended until June 2026 in view of the State Assembly elections. Tasmac, a major revenue generator for the Tamil Nadu government, currently operates 4,048 retail liquor outlets across the state. The cash cow of the state government generates around ₹150 crore in liquor sales everyday through its retail network.

TNEA 2026 rank list released; counselling from July 20

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The single-window counselling for admission to undergraduate courses in colleges affiliated to Anna University will begin on July 20, Tamil Nadu Higher Education Minister P. Viswanathan said on Wednesday, after releasing the rank list for Tamil Nadu Engineering Admissions (TNEA) 2026.

There would be three rounds of counselling for general category students opting for the academic stream, whereas those opt-

ing for vocational stream will have one round of counselling. Candidates will have until July 6 to get their grievances pertaining to the merit list redressed. The rank list and cut-off marks for each round of counselling have been released on the website www.tneasonline.org.

The rank list this year features over 2.36 lakh students.

Mr. Viswanathan said that this year, 50,494 students applied under the horizontal reservation category (7.5% reservation for those who studied in



Higher Education Minister P. Viswanathan releasing the TNEA rank list. M. SRINATH

government schools from Classes VI to XII), with 46,604 making it to the merit list. For general cate-

gory students who come under the special reservation category such as sports quota (3,183 students), differently-abled quota (493), and ex-servicemen quota (1,175), online counselling will be held between July 15 and July 18.

Similarly, for the horizontal reservation category students (499 students under sports quota, 149 under differently abled quota, and 14 under ex-servicemen quota), the online counselling will be held on July 13 and July 14.

In the vocational stream – for which the choice fill-

ing will be open between July 20 and July 22 – as many as 2,205 students under the general category and 524 students under the horizontal reservation category will participate.

Choice filling for the first round of academic counselling for general category students will be held between July 20 and July 22, where 37,976 students with cut-off marks between 200 and 171.333 will participate. The deadline to confirm tentative allotment or choose upward mobility is July 25.

Similarly, choice filling

for the second round will be between August 3 and August 5, with 93,117 candidates with cut-off marks between 171 and 135.75 taking part. The final round will have 1,02,719 candidates participating, for whom the choice filling will be held between August 17 and 19.

Students who find their names missing from the merit list may either approach the TNEA facilitation centres, or call the toll-free number 1800-425-0110, or send an email to tneacare@gmail.com for clarifications.

Timings

CHENNAI

THURSDAY, JUL. 02

RISE

05:47

SET

18:39

RISE

20:37

SET

07:32

FRIDAY, JUL. 03

RISE

05:47

SET

18:40

RISE

21:17

SET

08:22

SATURDAY, JUL. 04

RISE

05:48

SET

18:40

RISE

21:55

SET

09:12

THE HINDU

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Chennai Weather

max

min

Tiruvallur

40

26

Chennai Airport

39

28

Chennai City

38

28

Chennai Airport Today

36°C The weather will be very warm and uneasy. The night also will be uneasy. A spell of light rain and thundershowers may occur.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow

37°C The morning will be comfortable. The day will be very warm and uneasy. The night also will be uneasy. Mostly dry weather to prevail.

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Govt. of Bihar

GOVERNOR'S SECRETARIAT

BIHAR LOK BHAVAN, PATNA-800022

CORRIGENDUM TO ADVERTISEMENT

Regarding Invitation of Applications for appointment of Vice-Chancellors in the Select Universities of Bihar.

With reference to the following advertisements issued by the Governor's Secretariat for appointment to the post of **Vice-Chancellor** in the State Universities of Bihar:

1. Advertisement No. PR_003693/26-27 dated 20.05.2026 inviting applications for the post of Vice-Chancellor, Aryabhata Knowledge University (AKU), Patna.

2. Advertisement No. PR_003692/26-27 dated 20.05.2026 inviting applications for the post of **Vice-Chancellor** in the following five Universities:

- Lalit Narayan Mithila University (LNMU), Darbhanga
- Kameshwar Singh Darbhanga Sanskrit University (KSDSU), Darbhanga
- Bhupendra Narayan Mandal University (BNMU), Madhepura
- Babasaheb Bhimrao Ambedkar Bihar University (BRABU), Muzaffarpur
- Jai Prakash University (JPU), Chapra

3. Addendum No. PR_004884/26-27 dated 03.06.2026 issued in respect of the above six advertisements.

4. Advertisement Nos. PR_004705/26-27, PR_004706/26-27, PR_004707/26-27 and PR_004708/26-27 dated 03.06.2026 inviting applications for the post of Vice-Chancellor in the following Universities:

- Veer Kunwar Singh University (VKSU), Ara
- Maulana Mazharul Haque Arabic and Persian University (MMHAPU), Patna
- Tilika Manjhi Bhagalpur University (TMBU), Bhagalpur
- Magadh University, Bodh Gaya

It is hereby notified that the last date for submission of online applications for all the above advertisements is extended up to 21st July, 2026 (11:59 P.M.).

All other terms and conditions contained in the aforesaid advertisements and addendum shall remain unchanged.

It is further clarified that applications received after the extended last date and time, or applications found to be incomplete in any respect, shall not be entertained or considered.

By Order of the Chancellor
(Dipak Kumar Singh)

Additional Chief Secretary to

PR. No. 006891 (Governor Secretariat) 2026-27

The Hon'ble Governor-cum-Chancellor

For further details please visit : www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar

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OFFICE OF THE

General Manager-Cum-Chief Engineer

Electric Supply Area, 33/11 KV P/S.S. Dandih, Giridih, Pin- 815302

GSTIN No- 20AADCJ3148ADZ1, E-mail ID- gm.giridih@jbvnl.co.in

Corrigendum / Date Extension

In partial modification against e-Tender Notice No.- 165/PR/JBVNL/2026-27 for supply of Electrical Line Materials for AIIMS, Deoghar under ADP Head for F.Y. 2026-27 under Electric Supply Area, Giridih, extended scheduled dates may be read as follows:-

1	Availability of tender document on website	From 22.06.2026.
2	Date and time for submitting e-tender	From 22.06.2026 to 01.07.2026 up to 18.00 Hrs.
3	Last Date & Time of receipt of bid documents (Online)	03.07.2026 up to 17:00 Hrs.
4	Date and time of opening of tender i.e. Cover-I	06.07.2026 at 14:00 Hrs.

Other terms and conditions will remain the same.

स्वस्थित एवं राष्ट्रहित में ऊर्जा बचावें। कृपया अपनी शिकायतों को 18003456570(कॉल सेंटर) पर दर्ज कराये।

PR No. 382765

Sd/-
G.M.-Cum-Chief Engineer
Electric Supply Area, Giridih

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PERSONAL	PEST CONTROL
CHANGE OF NAME	NETLON SAINTGOBAIN SS Doortype SV Trading Authorised Dealer: 99490386715
	TENDERS
	BLOOMINGDALE APARTMENT OWNERS' WELFARE ASSOCIATION REGD No. (354/2019) NOTICE INVITING TENDER Design, Engineering, Procurement, Supply, Transportation, Unloading, Storage, Installation, Testing and Commissioning of a 450 kW (AC) Grid-Connected Rooftop Solar PV Power Plant, including supply of Solar PV Modules, Inverters, Module Mounting Structures, Balance of System (BOS), associated Civil, Structural and Electrical Works, Cabling, Earthing, Lightning Protection System, SCADA/Remote Monitoring System, Synchronization with TANGEDCO Grid, Net Metering, Statutory Approvals, Permits, Licences, Insurance during all stages of execution, Performance Demonstration, Training and Documentation on a turnkey basis, along with Comprehensive Operation & Maintenance (O&M) for a period of Five (5) years from the date of successful commissioning. CAG Approval mandatory. Minimum Pre-Qualification Criteria - Minimum 10 years of experience in Solar EPC. - Average Annual Turnover of Rs.12 Crores or above during the last three (3) audited financial years. - The bidder shall have successfully completed Grid-Connected Solar Power Projects with a cumulative installed capacity of not less than 10 MW, including at least one (1) Grid-Connected Rooftop Solar Power Project of 500 kW or above. Documentary evidence in the form of Work Orders and Completion Certificates shall be submitted. - Valid GST Registration, PAN and all applicable statutory registrations. - Positive Net Worth and should not have been blacklisted by any Government Department, PSU, Government Agency or DISCOM. Tender Schedule - Pre-Bid Meeting & Site Inspection: 07 July 2026 - Last Date for Submission of Bids: 14 July 2026 (up to 5:00 PM) Tender Documents Interested bidders may reach out: Email: baowaprocmement@gmail.com Phone: 9884353123 The Association reserves the right to accept or reject any or all bids, wholly or partly, without assigning any reason whatsoever. BAOWA Site Location: Bloomingdale, 143/352, East Main Road, Shankar Nagar, Pammal, Chennai – 600075

Metro Railway, Kolkata

Tender Notice for e-tendering is invited by Principal Chief Engineer, Metro Railway, Kolkata for and on behalf of the President of India for the following work: **Name of work:** Zonal Contract for maintenance of Green Line from Salt Lake Sector-V (SVSA) to Howrah Maidan (HWM) covering km (0.310 to km 15.657 including Central Park Depot and ancillary buildings in the Green Line corridor of Metro Railway, Kolkata. **Approx Cost of Work:** ₹2,10,53,214.64. **Earnest Money:** ₹ 4,21,100/-, **Completion Period:** Twenty (24) Months. **Date and Time of Closing:** 24.07.2026 at 12:00 hrs. The Tender Document and other details can be obtained from the website www.irops.gov.in. Amendments/Corrigendum, if any, would be hosted only on the website. **Abridged e-Tender Notice No.:** Civil-2586-2026 (Open)

Follow us at: t.me/metrorailwaykol / t.me/metroraikolkata

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

For and or behalf of the India invited e-open tender (E-Tender Notice No. 40265268) from experienced contractor for the work given below:- (1)**Tender Title:** Set of Spare items for Brake System, Qty. 05 Nos. (2)**Approx. cost of the Tender:** Rs. 1,06,27,811.60/-(Rupees One Crore Six Lakh Twenty Seven Thousand Eight Hundred Eleven and Sixty Paise Only) (3)**Earnest Money to be deposited:** Rs. 2,12,560/- (Rupees Two Lakh Twelve Thousand Five Hundred Sixty only) (4)**Date & time for submission of tender and opening of tender:** Tender submission date & time: Up to 14.00 Hrs. 30/07/2026 Opening date & time: After 14.00 Hrs30/07/2026 (5)**Website particulars** notice board location where complete details of tender can be seen and address of the office from where the tender can be purchased etc: Website:- <https://www.irops.gov.in> Railway administration reserves the right to postponed/modify or to cancel the tender any time without assigning any reasons. **SR DMM/STORES/SEE E.C. Railway, Sonpur** PR/0486/SEE/STORE/7/26-27/32

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Mathangi, 24992672

Today 6 p.m. E R Anirudh & Party. Ragasudha Hall.

Pushpanjali Cultural Trust

Today 5.30 p.m. at R.K Swamy Auditorium Mylapore Bharathanatyam by students of Ms. Soundarya Velmurugan 7 p.m. Bharathanatyam by students of Shri Pandiyan Shanmugam (Kancheepuram)

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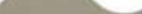
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AND LEADING OPTICIANS

Foreign Medical Graduates can intern at 36 non-teaching hospitals in the State

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Foreign Medical Graduates (FMG) can now undergo Compulsory Rotatory Medical Internship (CRMI) in 36 non-teaching hospitals – 23 district headquarters hospitals and 13 other hospitals – in Tamil Nadu. With this, a total of 1,504 internship positions would be available for FMGs every year.

This has fulfilled a long-pending demand of hundreds of FMGs, who had passed the Foreign Medical Graduate Examination and were waiting for the mandatory CRMI. After this issue was continuously pursued with the National Medical Commission (NMC), permission was granted for FMGs to undergo CRMI training in 23 district headquarters hospitals and 13 other hospitals in the State, a press release issued by the Health Department said.

Already, 384 internship positions were available at

the government medical college hospitals.

Now, 750 positions in district headquarters hospitals and 370 positions in other hospitals have been created.

Long wait

While this has resolved the issue faced by FMGs who have been waiting for CRMI training for long, they will be posted for the first time at district headquarters hospitals, thereby strengthening healthcare services for the public.

The list of district headquarters hospitals, institutions attached to government medical colleges and other non-teaching institutions, including private hospitals, along with the number of FMG interns to be accommodated has been published.

Candidates who have passed the FMGE examination can apply for the CRMI at the listed hospitals through the website: <https://fmg.tnmedicalonline.co.in>.

Metro Rail to build tunnel from Thirumayilai to Boat Club via Alwarpet in August

Two tunnel boring machines are being lowered and assembled at the Thirumayilai station as part of the work; tunnelling on the 2.2-km metro stretch was previously scheduled to begin in June

TRACK TALES

Sunitha Sekar
CHENNAI

Building underground networks for the upcoming Chennai Metro Rail's phase II project is gradually expanding to more areas in the southern parts of the city now. A few months after one section of underground network was completed from Light House to Thirumayilai, the next one from Thirumayilai towards Boat Club is all set to commence in the first week of August.

Previously, the tunnelling at the 2.2-km stretch from Thirumayilai to Boat Club was scheduled to begin in June.

Three metro corridors—Madhavaram to SIPCOT (corridor 3), Poonamallee



Work apace: Officials expect the tunnelling work to be completed in nearly a year and a half. M. SRINATH

to Light House (corridor 4), and Madhavaram to Sholinganallur (corridor 5)—form the 118.9-km phase II project.

This 2.2-km underground stretch comes under corridor 4.

Two tunnel boring machines (TBM) are being lowered and assembled at Thirumayilai station. Once launched, both these machines will pass through two stations—Alwarpet and Bharathidasan Road—and

will be taken out at Boat Club station. First, the TBM in the down line will start the drilling process and it will be followed in the upline.

“This is because from Thirumayilai till Bharathidasan Road, the tunnels are planned in a stacked pattern. It means, one tunnel will be above the other. In other locations, the tunnels are built next to each other (side by side). Tunnels are built in a stacked

pattern for various reasons including if there isn't adequate underground space,” a source said.

According to officials of Chennai Metro Rail Limited (CMRL), they are expecting to bore through some hard rock and also clayey soil from Thirumayilai to Bharathidasan Road which could slow down the tunnelling work during the initial stage. “Drilling into hard rock continuously could demand frequent changing of the cutter discs of TBM (the tool which helps in excavation). But after Bharathidasan Road, the machines may mostly encounter only clayey soil and the machines can easily drill through and complete the process,” an official said.

It could take nearly a year and half to complete the tunnelling from Thirumayilai to Boat Club.

Co-education system in undergraduate courses launched in Pachaiyappa's College

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Minister for Higher Education P. Viswanathan inaugurated the co-educational system at the undergraduate level at the 184-year-old Pachaiyappa's College on Wednesday.

About 50 women students have enrolled in undergraduate courses, and admissions have been extended till August 15.

“Co-education is very important. When we say a country is developed, we measure it by the percentage of women receiving education. So, of all things, women's education is of utmost importance,” said Mr. Viswanathan. He also spoke about how the college has produced former Chief Ministers, IAS and IPS officers, judges, writers, and other distinguished personalities.

Principal of the college, Baby Gulnaz, said that the institution had introduced co-education to inculcate equality and a healthy

competitive spirit in classrooms. “Opportunities should be given to women, and the co-education system is a step towards empowerment. Moreover, the learning environment will become more inclusive which is necessary for students,” she said.

A first-year B.Sc. Chemistry student Thanuja M., said she was looking forward to pursuing her college education. “I am the first girl to apply for and get admission to the B.Sc Chemistry programme. I consider this as an opportunity because I have faced many hardships growing up. Even though I am nervous, I will make the best use of it,” said Ms. Thanuja.

V. Parthiban, former judge, Madras High Court, and administrator of Pachaiyappa's Trust spoke about the values that students need to uphold in a co-educational system. C. Duraikannu, secretary, Pachaiyappa's Trust, was also present.



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HIGHER EDUCATION DEPARTMENT
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Phone: 0674-2954600 | Website: <https://dhe.odisha.gov.in> | Mail: rusa.odisha@gmail.com

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL

Higher Education Department, invites sealed tenders from eligible bidders for the following work :

The complete set of bidding documents and other details are available at <https://dhe.odisha.gov.in>.

EMD ₹ 5,00,000/-

Last date for submission of bids: **23.07.2026 up to 4:00 PM**

Opening of technical bids: **24.07.2026 at 4:00 PM**

Sr.No.	Name of the Work	Tender No.	Tender Fee
1.	Procurement, Supply, Installation & Commissioning of Laboratory Equipment & its accessories for Berhampur University, Ganjam under Regional Directorate of Education, Berhampur approved under PM-USHA	PM-USHA : 02 / 2026	₹ 10,000/- + Applicable GST

Bids must be sent via Speed/Registered Post only to :
Joint Secretary to Govt.-cum-SPD (RUSA/PM-USHA), Higher Education Dept., Lokaseva Bhavan, Bhubaneswar-751001.

Sd/- **Joint Secretary-cum-SPD (PM-USHA)**

11001/182/2627 OIPR-11001/11001/1/26-27/0020

SOUTH EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE

Sr.No. (1) E-Tender No.: 07-ST-TENDER-2026, Date: 24.06.2026

Work: "Provision of a Train Movement Monitoring System through a Data-Logger for control boards in the Bilaspur Division."

Tender Value: Rs. 2,96,33,187.32 (Rupees Two Crore Ninety-Six Lakh Thirty-Three Thousand One Hundred Eighty-Seven Rupees and Thirty-Two Paise Only)

EMD: 5,92,700/- (Rupees Five Lakh Ninety-Two Thousand Seven Hundred Only).

Submission of Tender: up to 15.00 hrs. on 16.07.2026.

The complete information of above e-tender notice is available over website <https://www.ireps.gov.in>. Bids other than e-bids shall not be accepted against above tender.

Divl. Sdg. & Tele. Engineer (CIC) S.E.C.Railway/Bilaspur
CPR/10/244

South East Central Railway | @secrail

THE HINDU

Air Surcharge as applicable:
New Delhi - Rs. 15/-
Port Blair - Rs. 20/-

ENGINEERING WORKS

E-Tender Notice No. DCBL/03/2026/NJP, Dated: 24-06-2026. Open E-Tenders are invited by the undersigned for the following works: **Tender No.: DCBL032026NJP**. Name of works: (A) Design, fabrication & construction of PEB (pre-engineered Building) structure for testing lab, Inspection record room, equipment room, including other accessories at New Jalpaiguri/Pandu/Silchar in connection with Bridge rehabilitation works on N F Railway. (B) Construction of SHED for storage of UC Span Railway Bridge components of 6*155', 1*258' & 1*338' at New Jalpaiguri. Approximate Tender Value: ₹12,73,07,060.01; Bid Security: ₹25,46,200.00. Date of closing of Tender: 20-07-2026 at 15:00 hrs. Date of Opening of Tenders: 20-07-2026 at 15:05 hrs. at Deputy Chief Engineer/ Bridge-Line/New Jalpaiguri (W.B.). For details please visit www.ireps.gov.in. Dy. CE/Bridge-Line/New Jalpaiguri

NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY
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S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

For and on behalf of the President of India, the Chief Engineer (CON)/S, South Eastern Railway, Garden Reach, Kolkata-700043 invites E-tender for the following work. Following tender has been uploaded on website www.ireps.gov.in. The tender will be closed at 12:00 hrs, on due date.

e-Tender Notice No.: 4640-GRC-CE-C-SO-23-2026, Date: 30.06.2026, Brief Description of work: Construction of Road Over Bridge, Approach Road, Quarters etc, in connection of Nimpura Reception Yard-Kharagpur 3rd line work under jurisdiction of Dy. CE/Con/II/Kharagpur, South Eastern Railway, Kharagpur. Approx. Cost: ₹ 65.31 Crore. Bid Security: ₹ 1,30,61,300. Completion Period: 18 months. Closing Date: 28.07.2026. Interested tenders may visit website www.ireps.gov.in for full details/description/specification of the tenders and submit their bids online. In no case manual tender for this item will be accepted. **N.B.:** Prospective bidders may regularly visit www.ireps.gov.in to participate in all other tenders. (PR-401)

CORRIGENDUM NO. 05 AGAINST TENDER NOTICE NO. CON/2026/APR/02 DATED: 20-04-2026

Corrigendum- 05 for Tender No. CE-CON-DK-EPC-2026-02 has been published. For details please visit www.ireps.gov.in Chief Engineer/CON/NL Project, Maligaon

NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY
(Construction Organisation)
"Serving Customers With A Smile"

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY

Tender No: EL/50/06/2026-27 Dt. 26.6.2026

E-Tender Notice
Dy.CEE(W), NWR, Ajmer on behalf of The President of India invites E-Tender for the following work up to 15.00Hrs. on the mention date. 1. **Tender No.:- EL/50/06/2026-27**, 2. **Name of work:-** Various Types of Modification work for REBC of LHB/EOG Coaches for 24. month at Carriage Workshop Ajmer. 3. **Approximate cost:-** Rs. 2177089.48/- 4. **Earnest money:-** Rs. 434200/- 5. **Date & Time of closing of E-Tender Date & Time of opening of E-Tender:-** 13-07-2026 at 15:00 Hrs. 13-07-2026 at 15:30 Hrs. 6. **The details of above E-Tender is available on website:-** www.ireps.gov.in.

929-DO/26
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NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY

E-Tender Notice No.:- SNT-JU-09-2026-27

Open E-tender is invited by DRM(S&T), Jodhpur for and on behalf of the President of India for S&T work. Details as below. 1. **E-Tender Notice No.:- SNT-JU-09-2026-27**, 2. **Name of Work:-** Provision for reliability improvement and upkeep of IPIS equipment's over Jodhpur Division. 3. **Estimated cost of the work:-** Rs. 1,58,05,009/- (RO) 4. **Address of the NIT Issuing office:-** Sr.Dy. CE/JU NWR, DRM Office Harish Joshi Marg Jodhpur. 5. **Earnest money to be deposited:-** Rs. 3,16,100/- 6. **Completion period:-** 36 Months. 7. **Last Date & time for submission of E-tender and opening of tender:-** 23/07/2026 Upto 15:00 Hrs through E-tendering online submission on IREPS. Tender will be opened at 15:00 Hrs. 8. **Website particulars, where complete details of tender can be seen and participated:-** www.ireps.gov.in **Note:** This is a E-Tender, so tenderer can participate through e-tendering process only on mentioned website

933-DO/26
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RAMAN RESEARCH INSTITUTE
SADASHIVANAGAR, BENGALURU – 560 080

Adv. No. 18/2026 Dt. 30.06.2026

Raman Research Institute is a premier autonomous institute engaged in research in basic sciences funded by the Government of India. The Institute is inviting online applications for various scientific and technical posts on direct recruitment basis. Last date to submit online applications is **31 July 2026, till 11:59 pm**. For more details, please visit : <https://www.rrri.res.in/careers/other-openings>

Sd/- Administrative Officer

STORES E-PROCUREMENT

Tender Notice No.: S/66/006/26-27, Dated: 26-06-2026. E-Tenders are invited by the undersigned for the following works:-

SN. 1: Tender No. NJ265055;

Closing/ Opening Date: 16-07-2026

Brief Description & Qty: Supply of Compressor unit of HHP Diesel Locomotive. Consignee: SSE/D/Silguri Jn., NFR; Qty: 05 Nos.

NOTE:- For full details of Tender notice and tender documents, tenderer may log on to the website (www.ireps.gov.in) prospective bidder who intend to participate in above tenders are required to log in themselves with the above website and submit their offer electronically, if they are already registered with IREPS. In case they are not registered with IREPS, they are advised to obtain Class-III Digital Signature Certificate from the certifying agencies under Govt. of India IT Act 2000 and participate in the above tenders.

Dy. Chief Material Manager, New Jalpaiguri

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CSIR Road, CSIR Campus, Taramani, Chennai-600113.
CSIR-CEERI अधिसूचना सं. NOTIFICATION No.EE/02/2026

वॉक-इन-इंटरव्यू / Walk-in-Interview

पद / Position (s)	Junior Research Fellows (JRF's) - 2 Nos.
पात्रता मानदंड और अन्य विवरण Eligibility Criteria and other details	Visit website www.csircmc.res.in and click on "careers"
साक्षात्कार की तिथि Date of Interview	21.07.2026

प्रशासनिक अधिकारी / ADMINISTRATIVE OFFICER

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY

TENDER NOTICE NO-06 dt. 30.06.2026

Invitation of tenders through e-Procurement system

Principal Chief Material Manager, North Eastern Railway, Gorakhpur- 273012 and on behalf of The President of India, invites tenders through e-procurement system for the supply of the following items. Complete description of the item and other condition are available on www.ireps.gov.in

Item No	Tender Number	Due On	Brief Description of Stores	Qty.
1	22261108	01/09/26	Secondary vertical damper etc.	1661 Nos.
2	22261810	24/08/26	Maintenance kit 02 for Earthing equipment.	1392 Nos.
3	22261486	20/08/26	Bite Type fittings for Brake piping etc.	58 Nos.
4	22262443	19/08/26	Mounting Bracket as per RCF's Drg. No.	5200 Nos.
5	23251023A	17/08/26	Heat treated steel shot to IS: 4606/1983 etc	85587 Kgs.
6	22261240	12/08/26	Set of Control Arm assembly left etc.	758 Sets.
7	22262010A	06/08/26	Overhauling Kit for Leveling Valve etc.	2226 sets.
8	22261419	05/08/26	Spring Plank for CASNUB NLB bogies etc.	433 Nos.
9	22251489A	03/08/26	End wall door complete etc.	124 Sets.
10	28261405	27/07/26	Gentian Blue Enamel Paint (RAL 5010) etc	79000 Ltr.
11	30260487	23/07/26	Low Maintenance Lead Acid Diesel etc.	437 Nos.
12	22262325	23/07/26	POH kit for failure indication cum brake etc.	697 Sets.
13	22261086	22/07/26	Silent block for roll link to Flat Drg etc.	111220 Nos.
14	22261558	21/07/26	Top Side Bearer Liner of BOXN Wagons etc.	6432 Nos.
15	29261021	17/07/26	Contact Unit Assembly For IRS Electric etc.	3086 Nos.
16	30260372	17/07/26	120AH VRLA Battery for TL Coaches, each.	928 Sets.

Principal Chief Material Manager Gorakhpur

CPRO-S-30

Do Not Smoke Bidi/Cigarette in train

BENGALURU NORTH CITY CORPORATION

Office of the Executive Engineer, Sarvajnanagara Division, 9th C Main, HRBR Layout, 1st Block, Kalyananagera, Bengaluru - 560 043

No:EE/SGN/KPPP/TEND/06/2026-27 Date: 01-07-2026

NOTICE INVITING SHORT TERM TENDER (NIT) (Two Cover System)

(Through GOK KPP Portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> only)

The Executive Engineer (Sarvajnanagara Division), BNCC Zone-1, Bengaluru, on behalf of the Commissioner, BNCC invites tenders from eligible Contractors registered in Greater Bengaluru Authority or equivalent registration with CPWD/KPWD /Railways/MES/ National Highway or any State Government Organizations. For the construction of works detailed in the table below.

Sl No.	Name of the work
1.	Providing Thermoplastic Painting for Rumber strips, Lane Marking, Junction Markings, different types of sign boards, Pelican signals and Kerb stones, HRPC and other safety furnitures as per Traffic police requests in Sarvajnanagara Division. (Call-2)

Approximate Value of work: ₹.320.00 Lakhs, EMD: ₹.4,80,000.00 (1.00 lakh through e-payment balance ₹.3,80,000.00 through BG/FDR, should be submit before opening of Technical bid)

Calendar of Events: (1) Tender Documents May be downloaded from KPP Portal from **06-07-2026** (2) Pre Bid Meeting will be held on **17-07-2026 at 3:00 pm** 3) Last Date and Time for Receipt of Tenders is **24-07-2026, 4:00 pm**. (4) Date of opening of Financial Bid is **27-07-2026 after 11:30 am**.

Sd/- Executive Engineer, Sarvajnanagara Division, Zone-1, BNCC

Tamil Nadu Power Distribution Corporation Ltd.
Notice Inviting Tenders (E-Tendering Process)

Specification No.	Tender Inviting Authority	Name of the Work
04	CE/IT-RAPDRP	Provision of Digital Signatures for signing the Documents in SAP ERP Auto filling of GSTR Auto Read
02	CE/Vellore	Supply of 11KV Standalone structure material complete set
03	CE/Vellore	Supply of 11KV Gang operated Air Break Switch with composite polymer Insulators for Single pole
04	CE/Vellore	Supply of 11KV Double pole AB switch SB 6 Pole with insulators

For details of works / Procurement / Due date of submission / Opening, viewing and downloading of e-tenders, please visit the websites www.tnpscld.org, www.tenders.tn.gov.in, www.tntenders.gov.in

DIPR/2184/Tender/2026

SOUTHERN RAILWAY

CENTRAL WORKSHOPS : GOLDEN ROCK, TIRUCHIRAPPALLI - 620004 EXTRA DIVISION

E-Tender Notice No. CW/C/192/Maintenance of Bio-tanks/2025/OT Dated : 29.06.2026

"Maintenance of Bio-digester tank in POH coaches".

Value	Rs. 42,73,506.00 inclusive of GST @ 18%
Bid Security Amount	Rs. 85,500.00
Contract Period	12 Months
Tender Closing Date & Time	21.07.2026 @ 12.00 hours.

Assistant Works Manager, Carriage/ for Chief Workshop Manager / Golden Rock

BENGALURU SOUTH CITY CORPORATION
BOMMANAHALLI ZONE - 2
Office of the Executive Engineer, HSR Division, HSR Layout, BDA Complex, Bengaluru-560102.

No.: BSSC/EE/HSR-D/Tend-06/2026-27 Dated : 01.07.2026

INVITATION FOR TENDER (IFT)
Two Cover Tender (Through GOK KPP Portal only)

The Executive Engineer, HSR Division, GBA, HSR Division, HSR Layout, BDA Complex, Bengaluru-560102, invites tender from eligible Contractors registered in Bengaluru South city Corporation, or equivalent Registration with KPWD/ CPWD/ BWSSB/ Railways/ MES/ National Highway or any state Government Organizations for the Construction of works detailed in the table below.

Sl.	Name of the Work
1	Comprehensive development of roads, drain and other allied works in Harlur, Junnasandra village, Mahadevpura Constituency, under 2000 cr grant (Comprising of 3 works in G.O BSSC SI no-104, 105, 106) Package No 01-2026-27. Estimated Amount : Rs. 1000.00 Lakhs. EMD (One Lakh to be transferred through e-Portal & remaining amount to be provided in the form of BG/DD/FDR) : Rs. 10.00 Lakhs.
2	Comprehensive development of roads, drain and other allied works in Agara, Ibalur, Hosapalya in Bommanahalli Constituency, under 2000 cr grant (Comprising of 3 works in G.O BSSC SI no-90,91,92) Package No 02-2026-27. Estimated Amount : Rs. 1025.00 Lakhs. EMD (One Lakh to be transferred through e-Portal & remaining amount to be Provided in the form of BG/DD/FDR) : Rs. 10.25 Lakhs.
3	Comprehensive development of roads, drain and other allied works in ward no. 32, Kudlu ward, Anekal Constituency, under 2000 cr grant (Comprising of 4 works in G.O BSSC SI no-107, 114, 117, 119) Package No -03-2026-27. Estimated Amount : Rs. 1100.00 Lakhs. EMD (One Lakh to be transferred through e-Portal & remaining amount to be Provided in the form of BG/DD/FDR) : Rs. 11.00 Lakhs.
4	Comprehensive development of roads, drain and other allied works in ward no. 32, Kudlu ward, Anekal Constituency, under 2000 cr grant (Comprising of 5 works in G.O BSSC SI no-108,115, 118, 122, 124) Package No -04-2026-27. Estimated Amount : Rs. 1150.00 Lakhs. EMD (One Lakh to be transferred through e-Portal & remaining amount to be Provided in the form of BG/DD/FDR) : Rs. 11.50 Lakhs.
5	Comprehensive development of roads, drain and other allied works in ward no. 32, Kudlu ward, Anekal Constituency, under 2000 cr grant (Comprising of 4 works in G.O BSSC SI no-109, 110, 116, 120) Package No 05-2026-27. Estimated Amount : Rs. 1070.00 Lakhs. EMD (One Lakh to be transferred through e-Portal & remaining amount to be Provided in the form of BG/DD/FDR) : Rs. 10.70 Lakhs.
6	Comprehensive development of roads, drain and other allied works in ward no. 32, Kudlu ward, Anekal Constituency, under 2000 cr grant (Comprising of 5 works in G.O BSSC SI no-111, 112, 113, 121, 123) Package No 06-2026-27. Estimated Amount : Rs. 930.00 Lakhs. EMD (One Lakh to be transferred through e-Portal & remaining amount to be Provided in the form of BG/DD/FDR) : Rs. 9.30 Lakhs.

(1) Tender Documents can be downloaded through website <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> from **02.07.2026**. (2) Pre bid meeting will be held on **06.07.2026 at 11.00 AM** in the office of the Executive Engineer, HSR Division, Begur main road, Bommanahalli Bengaluru-560068, to clarify the issue and to answer questions on any matter that may be raised at that stage as stated in "Instructions to Bidders" of the bidding document. (3) Last date submission of tender documents on or before **11.07.2026, at 16.00 hours** (4) Technical will be opened on the website <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> in the office of the Executive Engineer, HSR division on **13.07.2026, at 16.30 Hours onwards**.

Sd/- Executive Engineer, HSR Division Bengaluru South City Corporation



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SHRI AMARNATH JI YATRA-2026



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Tamil Nadu

From Page One

Three held for bid to bribe TVK MLA to vote against Speaker

Speaking to journalists at the Secretariat, Mr. Nirmalkumar claimed that several TVK MLAs were approached by alleged associates of Mr. Senthilbajaj and his brother. Offering the TVK MLAs up to ₹50 crore, they had told them that the DMK was planning to move a no-confidence motion against the Speaker, and had asked them to vote in support of the motion, he alleged.

He said one of the TVK MLAs who received such an offer lodged a complaint, based on which three persons were arrested. “That is why Mr. Stalin keeps saying that the government will not last long, and that elections will be held soon. The people of Tamil Nadu should closely watch what they are doing. After looting thousands of crores [of rupees] in the past five years, they are unable to remain idle, and are trying to purchase MLAs,” Mr. Nirmalkumar said.

“Is Mr. Stalin not ashamed of trying to buy MLAs? The people have already rejected him. Even his alliance partners have left after seeing the kind of politics the DMK indulges in, such as the attempt to make Edappadi K. Palaniswami (AIADMK general secretary) the Chief Minister,” he said. He claimed that those who saw no political future in the DMK and the AIADMK were leaving those parties.

Replying to a question on the pendency of corruption cases against former AIADMK Ministers C. Vijayabaskar and M.R. Vijayabhaskar, who are set to join the TVK, Mr. Nirmalkumar said the law would take its course.

When asked about the allegations made by the Minister, DMK organisation secretary R.S. Bharathi said they were only meant to counter the party's complaint to the Governor, seeking an inquiry into the alleged horse-trading of MLAs by the ruling TVK.

“The TVK has made baseless allegations, whereas we have submitted a complaint supported by adequate proof. When the police acted on the TVK's complaint and arrested a person, why is the same yardstick not being applied to our complaint,” he asked.

INBRIEF



Sri Lankan diplomat calls on Chief Minister at Secretariat

The Deputy High Commissioner of Sri Lanka to Southern India, Ganesanathan Geathiswaran, on Wednesday called on Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay at the Secretariat. Later, Axis Bank Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer Amitabh Chaudhry, along with senior bank officials, also called on the Chief Minister. Mohamed Rela, Chairman and Managing Director of Rela Hospital; G. Ramesh Krishnan, Executive Director; Mohamed Farook, Chief Operating Officer; and other senior officials of the hospital also met the Chief Minister.



Puviyarasu laid to rest with full state honours

The Hindu Bureau
COIMBATORE

Two-time Sahitya Akademi award-winning poet Puviyarasu, who died on Tuesday, was laid to rest with full state honours at Periyanaickenpalayam here on Wednesday. District Revenue Officer S. Madhuranthagi, representing the State government, paid official last respects to him before the funeral rites.

He received the literary award in 2006 for translating *Puratchikaran* (poems of Kazi Nazrul Islam), and for his poetry collection *Kaiyoppam* in 2009.



TVK, post-poll partners look to formalise alliance, steer it through co-ordination panel

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay holds discussions on framing a common minimum programme, and deciding on a name for the alliance, with leaders of the Congress, IUML, VCK, and MDMK

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The first meeting of the post-poll partners of the ruling Tamilaga Vetti Kazhagam (TVK) in Tamil Nadu, held at a private hotel at Kovalam on the outskirts of Chennai on Wednesday, signalled the formalisation of the arrangement into a political alliance.

TVK president and Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay held discussions with leaders of the Congress, the IUML, the VCK, and the MDMK on constituting a coordination committee to steer the alliance, framing a common minimum programme, and deciding on a name for the alliance.

Former Union Minister P. Chidambaram, Tamil Nadu Congress Committee president B. Manickam Tagore, Rajya Sabha member Praveen Chakravarty, VCK president Thol. Thirumavalavan, Minister Vanni Arasu, general secretary D. Ravikumar, IUML national president K.M. Kader Mohideen, Minister A.M. Shahjahan, MDMK general secretary Vaiko, and Tiruchi Lok Sabha member Durai Vaiko were among the participants. Senior TVK leaders, including Ministers N. Anand, Aadhav Arjuna and R. Nirmalkumar, also attended the session.



Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay with IUML national president K.M. Kader Mohideen at the meeting held at a private hotel at Kovalam on the outskirts of Chennai on Wednesday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Addressing a joint press conference after the meeting, which lasted over an hour, Mr. Tagore said it was the first round of discussions and all the parties had shared their views.

The meeting, held nearly 50 days after the government's formation, took place in a positive and friendly atmosphere, he said, adding that the aim was to take the partnership to the next stage by formally constituting the alliance. The next meeting would be convened soon, when the name of the alliance would be finalised and announced, he said.

To a question on whether the TVK would join the INDIA bloc, Mr. Tagore said Wednesday's discus-

sions were confined to Tamil Nadu politics. A decision on the TVK joining the INDIA bloc would be taken when the party secures representation in Parliament, he said.

Mr. Nirmalkumar described it as a “natural alliance”, and said their partnership would smoothly move to the next stage.

Left leaders meet Vijay
Leaders of the Communist Party of India (Marxist) and the Communist Party of India, headed by respective party State secretaries P. Shanmugam and M. Vee- rapandian, on Wednesday met Mr. Vijay at the Secretariat and urged him to prioritise the demands of farmers, agricultural la-

bourers, and construction and industrial workers.

Speaking to reporters after the meeting, Mr. Shanmugam said it was a courtesy call, as this was the first time they had met Mr. Vijay after he assumed office as Chief Minister. He said they brought to the Chief Minister's attention issues such as unemployment and vacancies in educational institutions, and sought his intervention in the alleged irregularities in the examination conducted by the Teachers Recruitment Board.

Welcoming the formation of the Singappen Special Force, he said the personnel must be sensitised to crimes against women and children. He said the State government was yet to frame the rules for the Labour Code, and that it must hold a consultative meeting with all trade union leaders while framing them. He said Mr. Vijay had promised to look into these issues.

To a question on the Left parties skipping the alliance partners' meeting, Mr. Shanmugam said they had already extended outside support to the TVK to form the government. “The support of the Left parties to the government will continue even though we are not participating in the meeting,” he said.

DMK seeks DVAC probe into alleged bid to poach its MLAs

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The DMK on Wednesday urged Governor Rajendra Viswanath Arlekar to order an inquiry by the Directorate of Vigilance and Anti-Corruption (DVAC) into what it described as an alleged criminal conspiracy involving Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay and MDMK general secretary Vaiko to induce two “DMK” MLAs to resign through corrupt and illegal means.

In his complaint, DMK organisation secretary R.S. Bharathi alleged that T.M. Rajendran, MLA from Kadayannallur, and R. Senthil-

R.S. Bharathi, DMK's organisation secretary, alleges that MLAs T.M. Rajendran and R. Senthilselvan were induced by TVK to resign from their Assembly seats

selvan, MLA from Sirkazhi, were induced to resign from their Assembly seats. Though both originally belonged to the MDMK, they had contested the 2026 Assembly election on the DMK's Rising Sun symbol. “The actions of Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay

and Mr. Vaiko amount to subverting the democratic process and frustrating the mandate of the people,” Mr. Bharathi said.

He pointed out that both legislators had contested as DMK-sponsored candidates after filing their nomination papers with Form AA, signed by the DMK president, and Form BB, signed by the party's general secretary.

Mr. Bharathi further alleged that since assuming office in May 2026, the TVK government had been persuading legislators elected on the symbols of other parties to resign and join the ruling party.

Referring to a speech allegedly delivered by Mr. Vaiko at his party's general council meeting, Mr. Bharathi said the MDMK leader had admitted that Mr. Vijay requested him to persuade the two MLAs to resign.

“Mr. Vaiko's speech, a copy of which has been enclosed in a pen drive, reveals that during a meeting at the Chief Minister's residence in Pattinapakkam, the Chief Minister discussed the issue with him for over an hour and suggested that T.M. Rajendran and R. Senthilselvan must be persuaded to resign from the Assembly. He also promised that he would

CM urges PM to relax certain provisions of VB-G RAM G Act

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI/VIRUDHUNAGAR

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Wednesday wrote to Prime Minister Narendra Modi seeking his intervention for critical modifications and relaxations of certain provisions of the Viksit Bharat-Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) (VB-G RAM G) Act, 2025.

He also requested the Prime Minister to continue the scheme in Mahatma Gandhi's name to honour his legacy.

Mr. Vijay said the VB-G RAM G scheme, implemented from July 1, imposes an additional financial burden of over ₹5,000 crore on the State government. However, certain provisions of the VB-G RAM G Act, 2025 require critical modifications and relaxations, without which the effective execution of the scheme would suffer significantly, he said.

On the fund-sharing pattern, the current guidelines mandate a 60:40 ratio between the Union and State across the Wage, Material, and Administrative components. As the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Scheme (MGNREGS) operated under a different structure for two decades, this abrupt shift places an unsustainable strain on the State exchequer, which may reduce available wage employment days or crowd out essential welfare schemes, he said. And so,

Mr. Vijay requested that 100% funding be maintained for the Wage and Administrative components, with the Material component shared on a 75:25 basis between the Centre and the State.

The proposed centralised methodology for classifying Village Panchayats and distribution within the State normative allocations introduces micromanagement. A uniform, formulaic national approach fails to account for regional socio-economic diversity and risks lopsided grassroots allocations. The State government should therefore be permitted to formulate its own customised methodology for intra-State distribution based on localised, ground-level needs, Mr. Vijay said.

Ex-Minister's criticism
Implementing the VB-G RAM G scheme without opposing the Centre would amount to failure by the State government in protecting Tamil Nadu's financial well-being and its rights, said former State Finance Minister Thangam Thennarasu.

The Tiruchuli MLA said that when MGNREGA was implemented, the financial burden on the State was under control. “The Union government's contribution was 90% and the State had to bear only 10% of the total expenses.” However, under the VB-G RAM G scheme, the State's contribution has been increased to 40%.

campaign for them if they contested the subsequent bypolls,” the complaint stated.

Mr. Bharathi said the alleged assurance amounted to an inducement to horse-trading of elected representatives. He also alleged that Mr. Vaiko had subsequently summoned the two MLAs before his party's high-level committee meeting and conveyed the Chief Minister's proposal.

The complaint also referred to the resignation of several AIADMK MLAs who later joined the TVK. While acknowledging that each case might have different factual circumstances,

Mr. Bharathi argued that the pattern warranted an independent investigation into whether there had been a systematic attempt to alter the composition of the Legislative Assembly through negotiated resignations rather than through the constitutional electoral process.

Appealing to the Governor, he said that as the constitutional head of the State, he could not remain indifferent to the allegations. “Please do not turn a blind eye to blatant horse-trading and corrupt practices allegedly committed by the ruling party and the Chief Minister..,” he said.

AIADMK rebels unwilling to accept new posts in the party

T. Ramakrishnan
CHENNAI

The AIADMK rebels, including former Ministers S.P. Velumani, P. Thangamani, and K.P. Anbalagan, have conveyed to party general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami their unwillingness to accept the new posts assigned to them.

After the dissidents went against the party's stand to oppose the vote of confidence motion moved by Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay in the Assembly on May 13, Mr. Palaniswami sacked 26 district secretaries. A few days later, he eased out more district secretaries from their posts. On June 25, the general secretary did not restore the post of district secretary to any of the deposed functionaries, but offered them other positions. Mr. Velumani and another senior rebel, Natham R. Viswanathan, were made deputy general secretaries. At the same time, former Law Minister C.Ve.

Shanmugam, a bitter critic of Mr. Palaniswami, was not given any post. Mr. Velumani, while addressing a meeting in Coimbatore last Sunday, wondered how he would accept the position when many of his colleagues had not been “properly accommodated” within the organisation.

In a letter jointly signed, nine rebels accused Mr. Palaniswami of “not respecting” what was agreed between them at the time of truce in May, when the two MLA camps withdrew their complaints against each other for disqualification. Their communication, dated June 30, said the present state of affairs had arisen because of Mr. Palaniswami's move to form a government with the DMK's help. Mr. Viswanathan; former Ministers K.C. Vee- ramani and P. Balakrishna Reddy; and former secretaries of the Tenkasi (north), Ranipet (west) and Cuddalore (west) units C. Krishnamurali, S.M. Suku-

mar, and A. Arunmozhithevan were the other signatories. Mr. Shanmugam was not a part of this group of rebels.

Mr. Thangamani and Mr. Anbalagan told *The Hindu* that they would prefer to remain “ordinary volunteers” of the party.

Asked whether they would switch over to the TVK or the DMK, they emphatically said they would not leave the organisation, and clarified that they were not against the party leadership.

Women's wing meet
Meanwhile, the AIADMK women's wing resolved to work hard for the party's success in the forthcoming by-elections to several Assembly constituencies and the local bodies' polls. This comes after Mr. Palaniswami, who chaired the meeting at party headquarters in Chennai, encouraged them to strengthen the organisation, and rope in more women.

Post-mortem done on body of youth found dead in Mayiladuthurai

The Hindu Bureau
TIRUCHI

A day after a 19-year-old youth and a 17-year-old girl belonging to different castes were found dead in a thatched shed at Sathangu- di in Mayiladuthurai district, a post-mortem was conducted on the youth's body on Wednesday.

Officials said the youth's parents agreed to a post-mortem after police and revenue officials held talks with them at the Tharangambadi taluk office. Representatives of the VCK and the CPI(M), Revenue Divisional Officer of Sirkali, and Deputy Superintendent of Police, Mayiladuthurai and Sirkazhi were present. Superintendent of Police (in-charge), Mayiladuthurai, the Minister, joined the meeting later.

During the meeting, the parents of the youth, who belonged to the Scheduled Caste, wanted the autopsy

to be conducted by a team of doctors and that it be videographed. Besides booking a case of murder, they sought a copy of the initial report of the autopsy, a free house site patta, and a government job for a member of the family, according to the police and revenue officials.

Police sources said the post-mortem was conducted at the Tiruvavur Government Medical College Hospital, after which the body was handed over to the family.

Girl's father arrested
The Poraiyar police on Tuesday arrested the girl's father, and four others under the SC/ST Act, on a complaint preferred by the youth on Monday, a day before he was found dead. The youth had alleged in the complaint that he was abused and assaulted by the father of the girl and a few others.



INBRIEF



Murmu urges youth to make learning a lifelong pursuit

President Droupadi Murmu on Wednesday urged young graduates to make learning and innovation their lifelong pursuits. She said that the ability to adapt to rapid technological changes would define success in an increasingly knowledge-driven world. Addressing the first convocation of the Central University of Andhra Pradesh, she said India's youth were its greatest strength, and urged them to combine knowledge with integrity, creativity and spirit of service.

Kerala takes another step towards becoming 'Keralam'

The Kerala Assembly on Wednesday unanimously endorsed the President's reference on the proposal to officially rename the State from Kerala to 'Keralam.' The House considered the Kerala (Alteration of Name) Bill, 2026, which was referred by the President to seek its opinion. The legislators unanimously endorsed all queries raised by the President on the Bill's 10 clauses. Speaker Thiruvanchoor Radhakrishnan described it as a "historic moment".

Three killed as wall caves in amid heavy rain in Mangaluru

A woman and two girls died when a retaining wall collapsed on a building at Garodi-Naguri in Mangaluru on Wednesday. The retaining wall beside a residential building collapsed amid heavy rain, Police Commissioner Sudheer Kumar Reddy said. "We are investigating the structural integrity of the wall. Directions have been given to register a case against those responsible for any unauthorised excavation that may have increased landslide susceptibility," he said.

LOK BHAWAN ASSAM
Advertisement No. 01/2026
“Applications are invited for the post of Vice Chancellor of Assam Women's University, Jorhat, Assam. Interested candidates are requested to visit website of either Lok Bhavan, Assam - <https://lokbhavan.assam.gov.in>, Assam Women's University, Jorhat, Assam - <https://awu.ac.in> or Department of Higher Education, Govt. of Assam - <https://highereducation.assam.gov.in> - for details of terms, conditions, mode of application and Application Format. The last date of submission of application is 31/07/2026.
Sd/-
Joint Secretary, Governor's Secretariat,
Lok Bhavan, Guwahati - 781001, Assam
DIPR/DF/HIND 421 1-JUL-26

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH
OBITUARY

Smt. SARADHA SRINIVASAN
(age 86), beloved wife of the late T. S. Srinivasan, passed away on June 30th, 2026.
She is survived by her two sons, her two brothers and their families, who will carry forward her memory with deep affection and gratitude.
A cherished presence in the lives of all who knew her, she embodied grace and resilience, leaving behind a legacy of love and values that will continue to guide her family.
Ph: +91 95002 57308

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES
Remembering

S. Durairajulu
"P-P-Dynamic Ambitions on his 11th anniversary"
March 5, 1957 July 2, 2025
We are proud of the way you lived your life - as a loving father, devoted husband, caring grandfather, and a true friend to so many. Your kindness, warmth, and generosity continue to inspire us everyday, and we strive to carry those qualities forward in our own lives.
Your presence may be gone, but your love, values, and memories remain with us always.
You are deeply loved, dearly remembered, and greatly missed every single day.
9994048440

DEATH
P.R. Shankar Kumar
17 December 1941
1 July 2026, Chennai

A gentleman of infinite grace, with deep compassion for animals and wildlife, a love of nature, and a passion for reading, Shankar was a leader in India's early computing industry. He seamlessly blended art and science throughout his life and lived by his adage, "Love what you do."
We deeply mourn his passing and celebrate a life well lived.
Forever young, forever blessed.
Wife
Nalini
Daughters
Sujatha & Sharmila
(+91) 9840298241

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES
14th Anniversary

J. SHANTHI RAGHAVAN
You loved us, You made us, We love you forever
A. Jeyaragavan, Renuka, Gideon Devadasan, Joel Ragar, Julia, Capt. Kirupakaran, Deepa, Disha, Reena, Johnson & Abraham. **9832911495**

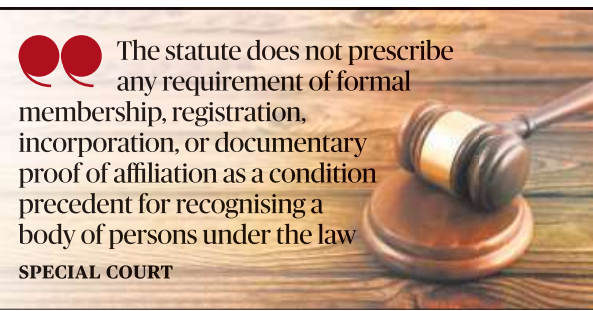
Special court rejects Priyank's claim in RSS defamation case

Judge terms Minister's contention that the RSS is not a registered organisation as 'devoid of merit'; refers to judicial precedents declaring the RSS to be a definite, identifiable body or class of persons

Krishnaprasad
BENGALURU

In a setback to Karnataka Home Minister Priyank Kharge, a special court in Bengaluru has rejected his contention that no member of the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) can maintain a criminal defamation complaint because the RSS is "not a registered organisation and it does not maintain any registered membership".

The court termed Mr. Kharge's contention "wholly untenable and devoid of merit" while referring to various past judicial precedents, in which the High Courts and the Supreme Court have clearly



declared that "the RSS is a definite, determinate, and identifiable body or class of persons; and consequently, where defamatory imputations are made against the RSS as an organisation, an individual member of the RSS is competent to maintain a complaint for defamation". Sandeep Patil, judge of the special court of magis-

trate for criminal cases against former and present MPs and MLAs in Karnataka, made these observations in his June 27 order of taking cognisance of the offence of criminal defamation under Section 356 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) against Mr. Kharge, and Mohammed Haris Nalapad, son of Congress MLA N.A. Haris, on a

Vizhinjam deal needs Kerala govt.'s nod: CM

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

A day after the announcement by Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone Limited (APSEZ) that the Switzerland-based Mediterranean Shipping Company (MSC) Group will acquire a 49% stake in Adani Vizhinjam Port Private Limited (AVPPL), the Kerala government on Wednesday made it clear that its approval was required for the MSC-Adani agreement.

Replying to a submission by Leader of the Opposition Pinarayi Vijayan in the Assembly, Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan said the proposed acquisition of a stake in the AVPPL by MSC had come to the attention of the government through media reports.

The port has strategic importance. The approval of the Union Home Ministry and the Union Shipping Ministry was needed, apart from the approval of the State government, he said.

The Hindu Bureau
HYDERABAD

Doctors at the Telangana Government-run Osmania General Hospital (OGH) here have performed a multi-visceral transplant, which is claimed as India's first. They have transplanted five organs – stomach, duodenum, pancreas, small intestine, and right colon – on one patient. The 36-hour marathon surgery was carried out on a 30-year-old engineer

defamation case filed by Bengaluru-based RSS member Tejas A.

Relying on Section 2(26) of the BNS, the court pointed out that the definition of "person" expressly includes "any company or association or body of persons, whether incorporated or not", and "the statute does not prescribe any requirement of formal membership, registration, incorporation, or documentary proof of affiliation as a condition precedent for recognising a body of persons under the law".

Whether the complainant is part of such identifiable group is a matter to be established by evidence during trial, the court said.

WEATHERWATCH
Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday

TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 18.00 HRS)

Forecast for Thursday: Heavy/very heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Jammu & Kashmir, Punjab, Delhi, Uttarakhand, Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Odisha, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Goa, Karnataka, Kerala and Mahe. Hot and humid weather likely at isolated places over Assam, Meghalaya, Manipur, Mizoram and Tripura

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala		34.2	27.2	Kurnool		1.9	33.7
Ahmedabad		39.5	29.5	Lucknow		0.6	34.8
Aizawl		50.4	31.2	Madurai		40.0	28.2
Bengaluru		27.3	20.9	Mangaluru		135.3	26.1
Bhopal		35.2	31.6	Mumbai		96.3	27.7
Bhubaneswar		0.8	29.4	Mysuru		28.0	20.0
Chandigarh		29.7	27.4	New Delhi		34.8	28.6
Chennai		4.6	35.8	Patna		36.3	28.6
Coimbatore		31.0	21.6	Port Blair		1.9	30.5
Dehradun		62	25.8	Prayagraj		5.6	35.4
Gangtok		4.5	22.2	Puducherry		37.8	28.8
Goa		55.2	28.8	Raipur		3.8	28.0
Guwahati		34.4	27.4	Rajpur		0.1	32.9
Hubballi		26.0	22.0	Ranchi		31.0	24.0
Hyderabad		31.4	25.2	Shillong		2.6	24.4
Imphal		30.1	25.8	Shimla		3.6	22.5
Jaipur		38.2	29.2	Srinagar		31.5	23.3
Kochi		22	28.8	Thiruvananthapuram		0.1	32.8
Kolkata		48.8	32.7	Tiruchirappalli		37.7	27.0
Kozhikode		40	30.2	Vijayawada		35.6	29.7
		30.2	23.2	Visakhapatnam		12.9	34.6

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing

CITIES	SO ₂	NO ₂	CO	PM _{2.5}	PM ₁₀	CODE	Yesterday
Ahmedabad		72	29	55		80	74
Bengaluru		15	30	53		109	
Chennai		5	14	53		41	53
Delhi		16	76	116		175	101
Hyderabad		13	16	26		64	86
Kolkata		17	25	47		75	90
Lucknow		11	32	34		54	59
Mumbai		8	27	56		26	33
Pune		18	101	25		30	30
Visakhapatnam		8	58	20		58	83

Air Quality Code: Poor Moderate Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO₂: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO₂: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM_{2.5} & PM₁₀: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

Government of Jharkhand
Directorate of Industries
Jharkhand Government Tool Room, Ranchi
(Formerly Jharkhand Government Mini Tool Room & Training Centre, Ranchi)
Plot No: 38, Phase I, Tatisilwai Industrial Area, Muri Road, Ranchi - 835103 ,
e-mail: info@jgtr.in, principal@jgtr.in, jgmtrtc_ran@yahoo.co.in Web site: www.jgtr.in
Phone No. 0651-2265966, Fax No.0651-2265578

ONLINE TENDER NOTICE
Govt. of Jharkhand has set up state-of-the art Tool Room & Training Centre at Tatisilwai, Ranchi, Dumka & Gola. The centres requires Machine Tools & Equipment as pertaining the details furnished in website.
Interested original Tenderer and /or their authorized representatives / dealers having permanent registered office in India and operating in India over last 5 (Five) years are eligible to participate in the tender.
The complete tender document including ITT, GCC, technical specification, price bid, cost of tender, EMD requirements etc. can be downloaded from the web sites www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in & www.jgtr.in from 2nd July 2026 onwards till 23rd July 2026 upto 3.00 P.M.
Note: JGTR, Ranchi reserves the right to reject the application of any or all the intending bidders without assigning reasons whatsoever.

Sd/- (Director of Industries)
PR.NO.383634 Industries(26-27):D

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER,
WATER WAYS DIVISION NO.2, HAZARIBAG.
e-Procurement Tender Notice No.- 01/2026-27- (C.S.R FUND).

Group No	Scheme Name	Estimated Cost (In Rs.)	Time of Completion
1.	पर्यटन विभाग द्वारा B श्रेणी में अधिसूचित पर्यटक स्थल छड़वा डैम में पार्क, बहुउद्देशीय मग्न, घाट इत्यादि के निर्माण एवं विकास कार्य	4,89,99,998.00	18 Months

1.	Date of Publication of e-Tender on website	20.07.2026 at 3:00 P.M
2.	Last date/Time for Submission of e-Tender bids Online	30.07.2026 up to 4:00 P.M (e-Procurement Portal- http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in)
3.	Last Date for Online Submission of Tender Fee and EMD	30.07.2026 up to 4:00 P.M
4.	Date of opening of e-Tender	31.07.2026 at 05:00 P.M
5.	Name & address of office Inviting tender	Executive Engineer, Water Ways Division No.2 , Hazaribag
6.	Contact no. of e-Procurement officer	06546-298163, 7903709450
7.	E-mail of e- Procurement officer	eeewdchak2-cer-jhr@nic.in

Note:- 1.) Only e-Tender will be accepted.
2.) Published Estimated Cost may be increased or decreased.
3.) Further details can be seen and Mode of Submission of Online Tender/Tender Fee/EMD through <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in>

Executive Engineer,
Water Ways Division No.2,Hazaribag.
PR 383637 Water Resource(26-27):D

झारखण्ड सरकार
भवन निर्माण विभाग

झारखण्ड सरकार के भवन निर्माण विभाग के लिए वास्तुविद् (आर्किटेक्ट) का पैनल तैयार करने हेतु अभिरुचि आमंत्रण सूचना
भवन निर्माण विभाग द्वारा Comprehensive Architectural Services हेतु वास्तुविद् (आर्किटेक्ट) का पैनल तैयार कर परामर्शी के रूप में चयन किया जाना है।
राज्य सरकार द्वारा अनुमोदित शर्तों पर इच्छुक वास्तुविद् (आर्किटेक्ट) से आवश्यक प्रस्ताव आमंत्रित की जाती है –
1. Condition of Engagement को bcd.jharkhand.gov.in में भी देखा जा सकता है।
2. Comprehensive Architectural Services हेतु सूचीबद्ध वास्तुविद् (आर्किटेक्ट) से कार्य कराए जाने के लिए राज्य सरकार की बाध्यता नहीं होगी। विभाग महत्वपूर्ण भवनों में आवश्यकतानुसार चयनित पैनल के अतिरिक्त अन्य वास्तुविदों की सेवा लेने को स्वतंत्र होगा।
3. वास्तुविद् (आर्किटेक्ट) इस आशय का शपथ पत्र समर्पित करेंगे कि उनके द्वारा दी गई सभी सूचनायें एवं समर्पित कागजात सही एवं सत्य हैं।
4. अभिर्यता प्रमुख, भवन निर्माण विभाग की अध्यक्षता में गठित चयन समिति का निर्णय अंतिम होगा।
5. अनुमोदित शर्तों के आधार पर प्राप्त प्रस्तावों की जांच के पश्चात् पैनल तैयार किया जाएगा, जो वर्ष 2026–27 से 2028–2029 (तीन वर्ष) तक के लिए मान्य होगा।
6. वास्तुविद् (आर्किटेक्ट), जो उपरोक्त शर्तों के तहत कार्य करना चाहते हैं, वे दिनांक— **02.07.2026 से 17.07.2026 को अपराह्न 05:30 बजे तक** bcd.jharkhand.gov.in पर ऑनलाइन आवेदन समर्पित करेंगे। हाईड कॉपी स्वीकार नहीं होगा।
7. विभाग में सूचीबद्ध वास्तुविद् (Empanelled Architect) जिनका Empanelment वित्तीय वर्ष 2025–26 में समाप्त हो रहा है एवं वे पूर्व में आवेदन करने में विफल रहे हैं, वैसे वास्तुविद् जो उपरोक्त शर्तों के साथ कार्य करने हेतु इच्छुक हैं, अनिवार्य रूप से ऑनलाइन आवेदन समर्पित करेंगे।
For more information kindly visit bcd.jharkhand.gov.in
अभियंता प्रमुख
भवन निर्माण विभाग
PR 383718 (Building)26-27*D



On curbing young adults on social media

Incumbent Prime Minister of the U.K. Keir Starmer recently announced a policy to ban social media for children under-16. This was part of an arc of initiatives and announcements in Australia, Indonesia, Malaysia, France, and Canada to curb children’s access to social media. This has triggered debates in India, especially at the State level, along the same lines.

The various contentions against a social media ban are not uniformly convincing. There is the argument that bans limit an “important source of information and learning” for children. However, the extent to which social media is used by children for learning is empirically arguable. It is also normatively questionable whether such platforms are an apt space for learning in the first place.

Scientific literature is full of intense debates regarding a clear and uniform correspondence between children’s usage of social media and harmful experiences. Young adults respond to similar online circumstances differently; more so in jurisdictions that are as socially, economically, and digitally variegated as ours. What is required, foremost, is to identify the conditions where a high degree of correspondence does exist, and understand who are the most vulnerable among the expansive category of ‘children’.

Ineffective bans

Meanwhile, there are numerous reasons why a ban for below-16s is unlikely to be effective. Curtailing access assumes that stout mechanisms of age verification exist on platforms. One must also be aware that age-verification allows social media platforms to collect sensitive identity data of under-16s. Bans tend to get circumvented by teenagers using the credentials of a willing family member or older peers. Even without external support, many young adults can manage to gain access though technological circumvention. There is also the



Vibodh Parthasarathi

is with the Centre for Culture, Media and Governance, Jamia Millia Islamia, New Delhi

Given the limited efficacy of bans, the alternative is to focus on the governance of social media platforms. This moves attention from those at risk to those contributing to creating risk

anxiety that bans could inculcate a wider culture of work-arounds among young adults – a behaviour which once ingrained could extend, in the years to come, to offline legal responsibilities too.

A combination of slack age verification systems and technological workarounds makes a mockery of a ban. Besides, the Australian experience has shown that ‘age-gating’ on social media platforms has pushed under-16s to migrate to less entrenched services; we are yet to know whether they are safe spaces.

Given the limited efficacy of bans, the alternative is to focus on the governance of social media platforms. This moves attention from those at risk to those contributing to creating the conditions of risk. Discussions on young adults’ safety offer a potent opportunity to deepen debates on platform governance in India.

Charitable arguments point at design defects in some social media platforms that drive cravings and dependence among under-16s. But let’s face it – addiction is central to the aims and operations of all service providers in the converged media environment. In fact, in the attention economy, platforms cannot compete without instituting, by design or deceit, some forms of dependence.

If addiction is the key concern, the Chinese response of capping screen time for children seems better directed. It amounts to the state mandating platforms to do what many concerned and informed parents do through other means. That said, in countries relatively less regulated, surveilled, and socially regimented than China, practices of borrowing credentials and technological workarounds to surmount screen-time caps will continue. Moreover, like bans, instituting caps requires age-verification, and will thereby legitimise platforms to harvest additional data of under-16s.

Limiting access and regulating platforms involve different

registers of monitoring and enforcement. In the case of a ban or caps on social media use by under-16s, two levels of enforcement can be visualised. The first is at the individual and household level; here, enforcing a ban, if feasible at all, would lead to intrusive forms of monitoring by platforms. The second will be at the platform level; a ban or screen time caps would demand age-verification and safeguards to privacy by platforms be rigorously enforced by the government.

Holding platforms accountable

The alternative is to legally oblige platforms to be transparent on their design, and provisions on safe spaces. Here, governments are likely to face structural and operational barriers. Governments that rely on social media giants to promote or protect their own interests are unlikely to push platforms to create transparent and accountable mechanisms. Furthermore, ensuring compliance on matters of design would make governments vulnerable to allegations of selective enforcement.

Evidently, the policy option of curtailing access is easier than that of making platforms accountable. Governments find it socially acceptable and legislatively convenient to make a case for age-gating. Devising effective and fair protocols that hold platforms accountable for their unwillingness to design safe spaces is far more complex.

Those advocating to curtail access should be cognisant of three matters. Foremost, they ought to evidentially make their case against social media platforms. Second, they should realise that bans or capping screen-time is nowhere close to a well-rounded regulatory strategy to tackle online safety. Finally, they must anticipate the burden on regulatory and judicial bodies that bans and their enforcement could lead to, and the perils to privacy that come with age-verification.

A new identity for Hyderabad

Global Capability Centres are the new vehicles driving growth in Telangana

STATE OF PLAY

N. Ravi Kumar

Global Capability Centres (GCCs) have emerged as the new identity of Hyderabad, symbolising a major shift for the Telangana capital. They are a new dimension to a city known for software development and which hosts large facilities of tech giants such as Microsoft, Google, Salesforce, and Amazon. Hyderabad is home to more than 355 GCCs as per reliable estimates. They work in the areas of cybersecurity, supply chain management, cloud computing, AI/ML research etc.

While the ruling Congress projects the continued rise in the number of GCCs, former Industries and IT Minister K. T. Rama Rao cites that the foundation for the growth of GCCs was laid during the previous Bharat Rashtra Samithi (BRS) government.

Those at the helm often reference the previous Congress and even the Telugu Desam Party governments of a united Andhra Pradesh for the present growth of Hyderabad, making it evident that policy continuity over the years seems to have been crucial for the rise of the services sector.

Hyderabad is not the only location in India attracting GCCs. Much of its success in attracting global corporations has come in the face of rather stiff competition from cities such as Bengaluru, Chennai, Pune and Gurugram. Giving the city an edge is the existence of a strong tech ecosystem, talent pipeline, robust infrastructure, conducive policies as well as a responsive government. But the icing on the cake is the real estate – the land available to house more



GCC players as well as accommodate expansion programmes of existing companies. The lease rentals remain competitive and the infrastructure needed to complement the growth, from housing to entertainment facilities, continues to grow.

Speaking of the talent availability in Hyderabad, many GCC leaders don’t tire in underlining how the facilities give the employees a sense of belonging to a larger global team, building product and platform capabilities as well as accelerating the digital transformation process of corporations. Depending on the industry in which the firms operate, employees also get to work on latest technology.

The potential for growth

The headroom for growth is significant. A background on GCCs which the Government of India issued in December 2025 says there are more than 1,700 GCCs in India that serve as the offshore backbones of big firms and as powerhouses driving research, design, and development. They employ 19 lakh people. Their combined revenue increased from \$40.4 billion in FY19 to \$64.6 billion in FY24.

The GCCs, as opposed to back offices, are not operated by third parties; they function as integral parts of the global structure of the parent company to extend expertise across information technolo-

gy, research and development, customer support, and varied business operations. They also help achieve cost efficiencies by tapping into the ‘local’ talent pool.

As much as they have contributed to Hyderabad’s transformation, GCCs are changing due to the sway of AI. With new skills in demand, many of the GCCs are reorienting hiring strategies by sharpening focus on lateral hires and consequently giving rise to attrition. This has also meant fresh engineering graduates eyeing more jobs in IT firms.

But the contribution of GCCs to Hyderabad cannot be ignored, especially the thousands of direct jobs they provide. They have also opened indirect employment opportunities that have come as a temporary relief to those continuing to look for government jobs. Besides contributing to a changing skyline in Hyderabad, the GCCs are likely to play a key role in changing the contours of the city as the government rolls out plans for its proposed Bharat Future City.

Be it the Revanth Reddy-led Congress government or the previous BRS government, the rise of GCCs helped maintain the tempo of job generation, fuelled the local economy, and above all maintained the spotlight on Hyderabad. Governments should try to make these firms look beyond Hyderabad to tier II and III locations in the State.

However, for now, Telangana’s focus is on attracting more facilities to Hyderabad and as its IT and Industries Minister D. Sridhar Babu stresses, on turning GCCs into Global Value Centres. The Centre expects the sector to reach \$105 billion by 2030, employing over 28 lakh professionals.

ravikumar.n@thehindu.co.in

Under VB-G RAM G, States’ expenditure could go up six-fold

An analysis by *The Hindu* shows that States will have to spend at least ₹51,000 crore in 2026-27, in contrast to about ₹7,700 crore they spent in 2024-25

DATA POINT

Nitika Francis
Pon Vasanth B. A.

The Viksit Bharat Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) (VB-G RAM G), which completely overhauls the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA), came into force on July 1, despite serious concerns raised by many States.

One of the key concerns is the shifting of a significant part of the financial burden of this landmark employment guarantee scheme, which has been in force since 2005, from the Centre to the States. **Table 1** shows the key changes in the funding patterns.

Though the Government of India had earlier said that the transition to the new scheme “does not impose an undue financial burden on States,” it has not spelt out the additional expenditure to be borne by each State. A release from the Ministry of Rural Development on Wednesday said the Centre has made an interim allocation of ₹95,692.31 crore for the States for 2026-27, without mentioning the contribution needed from the States or how much of the interim allocation would be used to settle past dues for the States. This is despite a fundamental shift: MGNREGA was a demand-driven model while under the VB-G RAM G, the Union government shall have the power to determine the “normative allocation (budget to be spent on the scheme)” for every State in a year based on certain “objective parameters” the Centre prescribes. Moreover, the new scheme shifts the responsibility fully to the States for any additional expenditure incurred beyond the “normative allocation”; for unemployment allowance (if employment could not be ensured for the guaranteed 125 days); and the compensation for delay in payments.

The general perception is that the earlier sharing pattern was roughly in the ratio of 90:10 between the Centre and the State; now the shift to a 60:40 pattern would result in a three-fold increase in States’ expenditure.

However, an analysis by *The Hindu* showed that the increase in States’ expenditure could be nearly 600%, when compared with 2024-25, the latest year for which actuals on expenditure are available. The analysis, based on conservative estimates, showed that States will have to spend at least ₹51,000 crore in 2026-27, in contrast to about ₹7,700 crore they spent in 2024-25. The projected figure does not include West Bengal. **Table 2** shows the country-level estimates and the method used to arrive at the projections, based on the new wage rates for each State notified by the Centre.

Minister for Rural Development Shivraj Singh Chouhan was quoted as saying that “no eligible rural worker should remain without work even for a day”. However, the government had come under criticism in recent years for failing to ensure even 100 days of work.

The Hindu’s estimates conservatively assume an increase of 25% in the total person days generated in 2024-25 instead of considering a minimum of 125 days of employment for registered households. For the administration and materials related expenditure, the analysis has applied the inflation based on Consumer Price Index (CPI) for the amount spent for each State in 2024-25. Uttar Pradesh, Tamil Nadu, and Bihar will be among States, whose expenditure could see an increase of 600% to 800% (**Chart 1**).

Chart 2 shows how MGNREGA expenditure had come down since 2020-21 despite the Government’s stated commitment to spend more for the scheme. Moreover, the report available for the year 2025-26 showed that the Centre had to clear ₹20,422 crore pending as dues to all States.

Overburdening the States

The data for the charts were sourced from the Ministry of Rural Department’s reports available online, Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation, Reserve Bank of India, Union Budget, and the VB-G RAM G Act



Table 2: This shows the rough estimates for 2026-27 under VB-G RAM G and the increase in the expenditure of States

Category	2024-25	2026-27 (projections)	Calculation method
Wages	₹73,335.05 cr	₹1,05,769.18 cr	25% increase in PDG for each State multiplied by new wage rates
Person days generated (PDG)	268.2 cr	335.25 cr	25% increase assumed (100 to 125 days)
Materials	₹25,985.44 cr	₹27,884.24 cr	Adjusted for inflation as per CPI for 2025-26 and 2026-27 (projected)
Admin	₹4,770.55 cr	₹5,119.14 cr	Adjusted for inflation as per CPI for 2025-26 and 2026-27 (projected)
Total	₹1,04,091.04 cr	₹1,38,772.56 cr	
Centre’s contribution	₹96,401.97 cr	₹87,804.25 cr	
Centre’s share	92.6 %	63.3%	
States’ contribution	₹7,689.07 cr	₹50,968.31 cr	10% for NE States, no cost for UTs without legislatures and 40% for the rest
States’ share	7.4%	36.7%	

Chart 1: This shows the top 15 States that will have to spend the highest amount under the new scheme. A few States will experience a six-to-eight fold increase in expenditure

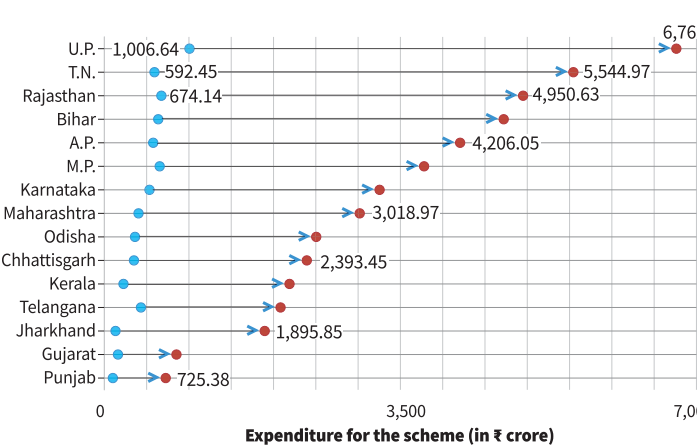
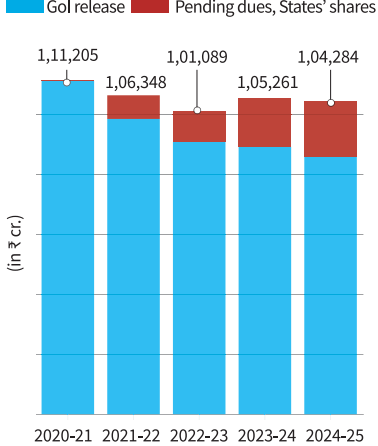


Table 1: This shows the key changes in the funding pattern between the two schemes (Centre:State)

Category	MGNREGA	VB-G RAM G
Labour wages	100% by Centre	60:40 ratio
Material costs	75:25 ratio	60:40 ratio
Administrative expenses	75:25 ratio	60:40 ratio
Number of guaranteed workdays	100	125
Exceptions for any States or Union Territories	None	90:10 ratio in total expenditure for NE States, Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand, and Jammu and Kashmir. Full expenditure to be borne by the Centre for UTs without legislatures

Chart 2: The Centre’s allocation has seen a decline. (Values above bars show total expenditure)



FROM THE ARCHIVES

The *Hindu*.

FIFTY YEARS AGO JULY 2, 1976

Modern lighthouse for Madras

Madras: The tallest and most-modern lighthouse on the coastline of Tamil Nadu is to be commissioned shortly. The 150-foot tower atop which the electrical equipment will be mounted is ready on the Marina in Madras (opposite All India Radio studios). It has been built at a cost of Rs. 12 lakhs.

The beam from the new lighthouse will be visible, even during the worst weather, (cyclone or storms when the air will be hazy) at a distance of about 20 nautical miles. The French-made lighting equipment is expected to be installed in a short time. It costs about Rs. 11 lakhs.

The light from the 3,000 watt bulb with numerous prisms, will have an intensity about 50 times that of the beam from the existing lighthouse in the High Court building.

The century-old lighthouse operated by kerosene will become defunct after the new one is switched on. Even in best weather, its range of visibility is only about 12 miles.

The new lighthouse is also unique in that it will have a lift to reach the top. All the other lighthouses in the State have to be climbed by steps. It will be operated by electricity but there will be a standby generator and also a gas unit to meet any contingency.

Though modern ships are provided with electronic gadgets still lighthouses are a necessity serving as lamp posts. The crew always look to them for their guidance.

The navigational aids provided to ships at sea are of two categories – general and local.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO JULY 2, 1926

Boon to the deaf

Rugby, July 1: Highly successful experiments have been made with the new apparatus designed by a Hull Civil Engineer named Calvard for overcoming deafness. Over 80 per cent of the children in Hull deaf and dumb institution have heard speech and music for the first time as the result of an invention which has the appearance of a small wireless receiving set without serial or earth connection. The results are achieved by the transmission of sound to the inner ear of the deaf patients. It does not succeed with all sufferers but only with a large proportion.

According to sources, many members felt that the clause provides adequate time for seeking bail and is in no way violative of the principles of natural justice. At best, the committee is likely to issue a caveat to prevent misuse of the law.

The Congress and the Samajwadi Party are constituents of the Indian National Developmental, Inclusive Alliance (INDIA). The two parties are also potential allies for the 2027 Uttar Pradesh Assembly election. Greeting Mr. Yadav on his 53rd birthday, Mr. Gandhi said the two parties would together fulfil the resolve for social jus-

In a separate post on X, Mr. Kharge extended birthday greetings to the former Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister and said the two parties

"Together, we will continue to advance the cause of social justice, inclusive development, and the strengthening of democracy and the Constitution,"

Former Jammu & Kashmir Chief Minister Mehbooba Mufti and five Shia clerics from Kashmir have also been invited by Iran.

The attack on Ms. Moitra came a day after Calcutta High Court asked the West Bengal government to frame guidelines for the transportation of the accused [mostly Trinamool leaders] in police custody. A Division Bench of Acting

The BJP president appealed to people to stop such attacks. Such instances affected West Bengal's image in front of the whole country, he said.

The inquiry will be further expanded to ensure that every angle is meticulously scrutinised, the official said. The SIT comprises Lucknow Divisional Commissioner (IAS) Vijay Vishwas Pant, IG (Range) Kiran S., and Finance Department Special Secretary Neel Ratan.

By assigning different roles to senior leaders, the exercise was an attempt to contain the intense factionalism in the State unit. However, the most notable omission was three-term Lok Sabha member Manish Tewari, who has spent more than four decades in the Congress and is one of the party's key faces ap-

Former Chief Minister Charanjit Singh Channi has been named chairman of the campaign committee, Vijay Inder Singla will head the election management committee, Sukhjinder

Committee and the Leader of the Congress Legislature Party in Punjab, respectively," said a statement from Congress general secretary (organisation) K.C. Venugopal.

A notification of the Appointments Committee of the Cabinet and Establishment said Mr. Misri will serve till July 14, 2027.

	NATIONAL BOARD OF EXAMINATIONS IN MEDICAL SCIENCES (Autonomous body of the M/o. Health & Family Welfare, Govt. of India) NAMS Building, Medical Enclave, Ansari Nagar, New Delhi – 110029	
NEET – PG 2026		
<u>NOTICE</u>		
National Board of Examinations in Medical Sciences (NBEMS) shall conduct the NEET-PG 2026 on 30-08-2026.		
The online applications are being invited from 01-07-2026 to 21-07-2026 at NBEMS website:		
<u>https://natboard.edu.in/viewnbeexam?exam=neetpg</u>		
Candidates are advised to carefully read the Information Bulletin before applying and not to wait till the last date to complete the online application process. No request for acceptance of an application through any mode after closure of the prescribed application submission window shall be entertained by NBEMS.		
Candidate Care Support: +91-7996165333	• Helpline Portal on applicant login page • Communication Web Portal on NBEMS Website	

INBRIEF
▼

The Delhi High Court on Wednesday held that the National Stock Exchange of India (NSEI) is a 'public authority' under the Right to Information Act. The Bench dismissed an appeal by the stock exchange challenging a single judge's decision which ruled that NSEI qualified as a 'public authority' under section 2(h) of the RTI Act. The court observed that if the body is owned, controlled or substantially financed by the government, it would qualify as a 'public authority'. It stated that this was not a case where an entity was established as a private company and was regulated by statute later.

The sales momentum in the passenger vehicles segment continued in June 2026 led by double-digit growth at most automobile companies. Maruti Suzuki India reported wholesales of 2,00,390 units in June 2026 as compared with 1,67,993 units sold a year ago, up 19%. Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles reported total wholesales of 63,083 units, up 69% YoY. Electric vehicle sales surged 183% to 14,800 units, including exports. In the domestic market, it sold 62,076 units, up 67% YoY. Mahindra & Mahindra sales stood at 1,06,207 vehicles, a growth of 37% including exports. Kia India, reported wholesale volumes of 24,552 units, a 19% growth YoY.

The National Company Law Appellate Tribunal (NCLAT) has said that the moratorium available to companies undergoing insolvency proceedings cannot be used to shield assets alleged to be proceeds of crimes, while upholding actions taken by the Enforcement Directorate (ED) under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA) against Siddhi Vinayak Logistics. It said if there had been any attachment by the ED, then the adjudicatory mechanism created under the PMLA alone would have jurisdiction to deal with it. “Tribunals constituted under the IBC are not forums which can entertain any plea against the ED,” it said. ^{PTI}

Russia has started sea-borne imports of gasoline from India, two industry sources said, in an effort to mitigate fuel shortages triggered by Ukrainian attacks on its energy infrastructure. Fuel shortages are being felt across Russia's 11 time zones with rationing, long queues at filling stations and a record gasoline price increase.

The Kremlin said on Tuesday that Russia was in contact with other countries and discussing imports of fuel at acceptable prices.

Russia's energy ministry and India's oil ministry did not immediately respond to requests for comment.

An industry source said at least 60,000 metric tonne of gasoline have been dispatched from India to Russia. Another source said that two tankers, with parcels of 30,000 to 40,000 tonne each, have been sent.

A third source said that in total, Russia plans to import 400,000 tonne of gasoline from various countries each month, including from neighbouring Belarus, which has already been exporting fuel to Russia.

Gasoline consumption in Russia is at least 1,10,000 tonne per day in summer, when demand for the fuel is high.

Godrej Pet Care (GPC) is set to cover all the southern States in the coming weeks and in a phased manner other regions on the back of its manufacturing plant in Nashik going on stream recently.

The Godrej Consumer Products subsidiary is also betting big on the country's demographics to aid pet adoption and the huge

Choosing Tamil Nadu for the debut and eyeing about 10% of the market there in about a year, the firm said it was entering Andhra Pradesh and Telangana. "We will be present shortly in Karnataka and Kerala and also some of the online platforms like Amazon," COO Nitin Jain said recently at the launch of Godrej Ninja pet food for dogs here.

"This is a sunrise category... for the future decades. The growth will be north of 15% for next few decades, largely because only one in 10 households has a pet [and the number] is only going to increase," he said, adding the need for a complete and balanced nutrition for dogs is another factor driving growth.

Citing estimates that pet care market at ₹6,000 crore of which ₹5,000

For exporters in the micro, small and medium enterprises (MSME) segment, the rise in freight costs due to the West Asia conflict continues to be a burden.

The cost for a 20 twenty-foot equivalent unit (TEU) container from Thoothukudi or Kochi to Colombo, which used to be \$400, is now \$600. There is no sign of the prices reducing yet, said V. Rangaswamy, president of the Coimbatore District Small Industries Association (CODISSIA).

"The containers that are stuck at the ports in the West Asian countries are absent in the market, leading to shortages. This is also pushing the costs up," he said.

For MSMEs in the engineering sector, steel prices are up almost 30%, copper and brass prices have doubled, and packaging prices have shot up. "The MSMEs do not have the margin to



Shipment delay: Containers are stuck at ports in West Asian countries, leading to shortages. GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCK

bear the steep hike in freight costs. Further, those who export perishables are hit by the wait for containers," Mr. Rangaswamy said.

Garment exporters in Tiruppur say that freight costs were up almost 200% for shipments to the U.S. and the European Union, and have started reducing now. In the case of exports to the West Asian countries, the cost for a 20 TEU container was \$300-\$350 and is now \$4,500, and for a 40 TEU container, it is \$5,900 from approximately \$700. Further, the ship-

ment period is two weeks longer, they said.

While a few buyers have come forward to share the costs, most of them do not. "The buyers are also under stress as inflation is up in their countries," added Mr. Rangaswamy.

The cost from a south Indian Port to Jebel Ali prior to the conflict varied between \$300 and \$400 for a 20 TEU dry container and \$900 to \$1,050 for a 40 TEU. Now, it has gone up to \$5,700 for a 20 TEU and \$7,500 for a 40 TEU container. Recently, there was a vessel from Kochi to Jebel

Finalisation of the India-EU Free Trade Agreement will be among the priorities of the European Union, Ambassador of Ireland Kevin Kelly said on Wednesday.

Speaking at an event here to mark the inauguration of the Irish Presidency of the Council of the European Union, Mr. Kelly described India as one of the "most important strategic

partners" of Europe.

“The European Union increasingly sees India as one of our most important strategic partners. Our presidency programme reflects that highlighting both the importance of the Indo Pacific and priority attached to the EU’s relation with India,” he said in this opening remarks.

“We hope to advance the Council’s works supporting progress towards the ambitious EU-India

Free Trade Agreement. We are pretty hopeful that this will happen during our presidency and I know there is a lot of work going on in the background to make that happen," the Irish Ambassador said.

This will be the eighth time that Ireland has held the Presidency of the European Union.

The EU-India FTA was concluded in January 2026 and is expected to be formalised later this year.

Manufacturing activity slowed to 54.2 in June, its second-lowest level in four years, according to a private sector survey. This was driven by a broad-based slowdown, including in new orders and output.

The only time the HSBC India Manufacturing Purchasing Managers' Index (PMI) was lower during the last four years was in



The broad based slowdown was in new orders and output

March 2026, the first month of the West Asia conflict. A reading above 50 denotes expansion in activity, while one below

50 implies contraction.

"In a nutshell, all manufacturing PMI indices for India moved lower during June," the report said. "In some cases this was a positive – such as input cost and output price inflation receding – while in others it pointed to cooling growth." It added that, due to the slowdown in total new orders and international sales, buying levels, employment and output also slowed.

 **Punjab State Power Corporation Limited**

Regd. Office: PSEB Head Office, The Mall Patiala-147001
Phone No.- 96461-18774, Email id- semeteringpatiala@gmail.com
Corporate Identity No: U40109PB2010SGC033813 Website: www.pspcl.in

Tender Enquiry No. MQP-265/2026-27/PR dated 30.06.2026

Chief Engineer/Metering, C-3, Shakti Vihar, PSPCL, Patiala invites e-tender for 1-in-1 Polycarbonate Meter Boxes (Cabinets) for housing Single Phase Meters for FY 2026-27.

For detailed NIT & tender specifications please refer to <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in> from 01.07.2026, 03:00 PM onwards.

Note:- Corrigendum and addendum, if any will be published online at <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in>

1079/12/2026-27/12869 C 692/26

 **Goa Public Service Commission**
Address: EDC House, Block C; 1st Floor, Dada Vaidya Road,
Panaji, Goa-403001 Tel. Off: 0832-2226687, 2223507
Email: sec-gpsc.goa@nic.in Website: <https://gpsc.goa.gov.in>

Tender No: COM/154/10/2026/001 Dated:01/07/2026

TENDER NOTICE

Name of the Work: Request for Proposal (RFP) For Implementation of Computer Based Examination System for Goa Public Service Commission (GPSC)

RFP is invited by Goa Public Service Commission for Selection of Agency for Implementation of **Computer Based Examination System for Goa Public Service Commission through e-Tendering Mode.**

For details, please log on to <https://eprocure.goa.gov.in> All interested bidders are requested to register for the e-Tendering portal of Government of Goa, if not registered, and should possess a Digital signature of Class III (Signing & Encryption) for participation. All Corrigendum and Addendum if any to the above tender/s will be published on <https://eprocure.goa.gov.in> and on GPSC website <https://gpsc.goa.gov.in>. The last date of online submission of bids in all respect is 30/07/2026 up to 17.30 hrs.

DA/UD/17784/2026


समुद्री उत्पाद निर्यात विकास प्राधिकरण
THE MARINE PRODUCTS EXPORT DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
 वाणिज्य एवं उद्योग मंत्रालय, भारत सरकार
Ministry of Commerce and Industry, Govt of India
 एमपीडीईए हाउस, पनमिल्ली एरवुन्, कोच्चि, केरल
MPEDA House, Panampilly Avenue, Kochi, Kerala - 682 036.
 दूरभाष : टेल: 0484-2319011 ईमेल : info@mpeda.gov.in वेबसाइट / Website: www.mpeda.gov.in

सहित परिपत्र VACANCY CIRCULAR

वाणिज्य एवं उद्योग मंत्रालय, भारत सरकार के वाणिज्य विभाग के अधीन एक सार्वजनिक निकाय, समुद्री उत्पाद निर्यात विकास प्राधिकरण (एमपीडीईए), वेतन निर्देशसूच सं.10 (₹56,100 - ₹1,77,500) (7.75 वें वेतन आयोग के अनुसार) में समूह 'च' में **हासिल पम्पिक्कल** के पद को सीधी भरती के माध्यम से भर्ती का प्रस्ताव करता है। आवेदकों को अपने अपने आवेदन अंतिमतादाय माध्यम से (www.mpeda.gov.in, अधिसूचना - अवरर - ओवेण्गल लिस्ट) प्रस्तुत करना होगा। विभिन्न भारी भार आवेदन-पत्र की सुविधा प्रती तथा विभिन्न दस्तावेजों सहित, सचिव, समुद्री उत्पाद निर्यात विकास प्राधिकरण (एमपीडीईए), एमपीडीईए हाउस, पनमिल्ली नगर, कोच्चि 682 036, केरल पर भेजी जानी चाहिए। शैक्षणिक योग्यता, अनुभव तथा अन्य विवरण (एमपीडीईए की वेबसाइट पर प्रकाशित अधिसूचना में उपलब्ध है)। अंतिमतादाय आवेदन प्रस्तुत करने की अंतिम तिथि 20 जुलाई 2026 (साय 17:30 बजे) है। आवेदन-पत्र की मुद्रित प्रती तथा अन्य आवश्यक दस्तावेज 24 जुलाई 2026 (साय 17:30 बजे) तक एमपीडीईए में मूल्यायन में प्राप्त हो जाने चाहिए।

(हस्ता/)
 सचिव

The Marine Products Export Development Authority (MPEDA), a Statutory Body under the Department of Commerce, Ministry of Commerce & Industry, Government of India, proposes to fill up the post of **System Analyst, Group 'A'** in the Pay Matrix Level 10 (₹ 56,100 - ₹ 1,77,500) as per **7th CPC** on Direct Recruitment. Applicants should submit their application through online (www.mpeda.gov.in, notification - opportunities - opening list). Print out of the duly filled application along with prescribed documents should be sent to the **Secretary, The Marine Products Export Development Authority, MPEDA House, Panampilly Nagar, Kochi - 682 036, Kerala**. Qualifications, experience and other details are given in the notification published in MPEDA website. Last date for submission of online application is **20th July 2026 (17:30 hrs)**. Print out of the application and other documents should reach the Headquarters of MPEDA by **24th July 2026 (17:30 hrs)**.

(Sd/-)
 Secretary

ଓଡ଼ିଶା ବିଦ୍ୟୁତ୍ ଗଠି
ଏଂଚାରଣ ନିଗମ ଲିଡ଼
(ଓଡ଼ିଶା ସରକାରଙ୍କ ଏକ ଉପକ୍ରମ)
Regd. Office: OPTCL Tech Tower, Janpath, Saheed Nagar, Bhubaneswar-751007



**ODISHA POWER TRANSMISSION
CORPORATION LIMITED**
(A Government of Odisha Undertaking)

NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER		
E-Tender No.	Tender Description:	Estimated Cost
CPC-29/2026-27	Bids invited from reputed manufacturers in two part bidding system for Engineering, Supply, Erection, Testing & Commissioning of Bus Protection system in PRP/HSRP and in compliant with IEC 61850 for different GSS of voltage level 400kV & 220kV with Panel. Last Date & Time of Submission of Bid: 21.07.2026 upto 13:00 Hrs.	Rs. 7,45,22,999/-
EIC. BharatNet-e-Tender-1/2026-27	Bids invited from reputed manufacturers in two part bidding system for supply of TYPE IIIA ADSS 24F/48F/96F OFC, TYPE-I. Last Date & Time of Submission of Bid: 22.07.2026 upto 12:30 PM.	Rs. 9,65,23,528/-
EIC. BharatNet-e-Tender-2/2026-27	Bids invited from reputed manufacturers in two part bidding system for supply of TYPE-I 24F/48F/96F ADSS accessories. Last Date & Time of Submission of Bid: 21.07.2026 upto 12:30 PM.	Rs. 1,46,22,808/-
CZ/BBSR-08/2026-27	Bids invited from reputed turnkey bidders in two part bidding system for supply & execution of associated AIS Nature of works towards construction of 02 nos of 33kV GIS feeder bays at 220/33kV GIS Grid Sub-Station Infocity-II under EHT (O&M) Division, Bhubaneswar under Central (O&M) Zone, Bhubaneswar on Turnkey basis. Last Date & Time of Submission of Bid: 27.07.2026 upto 12:00 Hrs.	Rs. 66,12,363/-
CZ/BBSR-09/2026-27	Bids invited from reputed turnkey bidders in two part bidding system for supply & execution of associated AIS Nature of works towards construction of 05 nos of 33kV GIS feeder bays at 220/132/33kV GIS Grid Sub-Station Chandaka-B under EHT (O&M) Division, Bhubaneswar under Central (O&M) Zone, Bhubaneswar on Turnkey basis. Last Date & Time of Submission of Bid: 28.07.2026 upto 12:00 Hrs.	Rs. 79,32,115/-
Complete set of bidding documents are available at www.tenderwizard.com/OPTCL and www.optcl.co.in .		
@ @ @ /optcl.odisha X /optcl_odisha HIPR-32/2026-27		

LONDON

Shipping companies, unions still consider Hormuz Strait a warzone



Unions and shipping companies said on Wednesday that they would continue to designate the Strait of Hormuz as a warlike operations area, after two ships were attacked despite a ceasefire between Iran and the U.S. Under the designation, covered mariners get paid double, increasing costs for shipping companies. AFP

NEW YORK

Two arrested after hanging banner on Empire State Building antenna



Two masked persons scaled the Empire State Building antenna on Wednesday, unfurled a banner about “the power of love”, embraced and took selfies before descending. Police said no injuries were reported after arresting the pair. Authorities are investigating how they gained access to the restricted structure. AP

NAIROBI

RSF committed ethnic cleansing in Sudan, says Amnesty International



The Sudanese paramilitary Rapid Support Forces (RSF) committed crimes against humanity and ethnic cleansing during their attack on El-Fasher city between 2024 and 2025, Amnesty International alleged on Wednesday. It said the RSF systematically attacked settlements which housed the Zaghawa people. AFP

BEIJING

China ethnic unity law comes into force despite overseas criticism



A new ethnic unity law came into effect in China on Wednesday, despite warnings from Taiwan, the United Nations and rights groups that it could threaten freedoms, especially for minorities. The Law on Promoting Ethnic Unity and Progress aims to forge a “shared” national identity among ethnic groups. AFP

U.S., Iran enter technical talks to secure peace deal, restart shipping

Jared Kushner, Steve Witkoff meet Qatar’s Prime Minister to prepare the negotiations but do not attend the Doha sessions; talks are based on MoU signed last month; Trump says talks are making progress and that denuclearisation is moving along

Reuters
DOHA/DUBAI

The U.S. and Iran held technical talks in Doha on Wednesday as they seek to agree on the flow of shipping through the Strait of Hormuz and secure a lasting ceasefire, a source with direct knowledge of the talks and an Iranian official said.

U.S. President Donald Trump’s son-in-law Jared Kushner and envoy Steve Witkoff met the Prime Minister of Qatar – a mediator in the talks alongside Pakistan – to lay groundwork for the negotiations, but would not be attending



Differing priorities: The talks in Doha are structured as sessions between chief negotiators and specialists, says the source. AFP

the discussions themselves, the source with direct knowledge of the talks said.

The talks are based on a 14-point interim accord

signed last month that was meant to halt the war that began with U.S.-Israeli strikes on Iran in February and reopen the Strait of Hormuz, whilst setting up

60 days of negotiations for a permanent peace deal. However, the U.S. and Iran have sparred publicly over the meaning of the interim pact, leading to tit-for-tat strikes over the past week. Iran is determined to win international recognition of its control over the strait and its ability to levy fees on ships entering or leaving the Gulf even if it has to do so by force, two senior Iranian sources said on Wednesday.

The talks in Doha are structured as sessions between chief negotiators and specialists, the source with knowledge of the talks said.

Iran has stated publicly

that its priorities include agreeing on management of the strait and the release of \$6 billion in Iranian frozen assets, and the Iranian official said the current round of discussions would focus on those two issues.

The stated priority of the U.S. is to ensure the free flow of traffic through the strait, the source said.

Meanwhile, U.S. President Donald Trump hailed the progress of indirect talks between the U.S. and Iran.

“As far as things are going, the denuclearisation of Iran is moving along well,” Mr. Trump told reporters on Wednesday.

Troops to stay ‘indefinitely’ in Lebanon, Syria, Gaza: Katz

Agence France-Presse
JERUSALEM

Israel’s Defence Minister said on Wednesday that Israeli forces would remain in self-proclaimed “security zones” established in Lebanon, Syria, and Gaza, without any timeline for withdrawal.

“The IDF will remain in the security zones in Lebanon, Syria, and Gaza indefinitely in order to protect our residents and communities from jihadist elements,” Israel Katz said.

“We will not withdraw from the security zones,” Mr. Katz said at function held in honour of Israeli soldiers killed during the 2006 war in Lebanon. He also reiterated an earlier warning to Iran, saying the Islamic republic would be struck with “full force” if it attacked Israel over its op-



Israeli army tanks positioned along the Israel-Lebanon border, as seen from Upper Galilee in northern Israel on Wednesday. AFP

erations in Lebanon.

Israel and Lebanon signed a U.S.-sponsored framework agreement under U.S. sponsorship on Friday to pave the way for peace between the two countries and disarm Iran-backed militant group Hezbollah.

Israeli officials, including Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu, have re-

peatedly ruled out withdrawing troops from southern Lebanon, where Israeli forces continue to clash with Hezbollah fighters. They maintain that any troop withdrawal would happen only after Hezbollah has been disarmed across Lebanon.

In Gaza, Israeli forces occupy nearly 70% of the territory.

Unchecked progress in AI may pose grave risks, warns UN panel

Reuters
GENEVA

Developments in artificial intelligence are outpacing scientific understanding and government policy, meaning there are no guarantees the technology will not cause catastrophic harm, a United Nations independent panel warned on Wednesday.

A preliminary report by the UN’s Independent International Scientific Panel on Artificial Intelligence said policymakers face a growing dilemma: they need robust evidence to regulate AI effectively, yet such evidence is struggling to keep pace with the technology’s rapid evolution.

Ability to adapt

“AI capabilities are outpacing both scientific understanding and governments’ ability to adapt,” said Yoshua Bengio, co-chair of the panel, comprised of 40 cross-regional experts.

“With growing evidence of deceptive AI behaviour, science currently cannot guarantee that as capabilities continue to increase, AI will not cause catas-

The world cannot govern what it cannot understand, says United Nations Secretary-General

trophic harm, either on its own or due to malicious users.” Described as the first global independent assessment of AI’s risks and opportunities, the report aims to give up-to-date evaluations of the science to help guide decision-making as governments contend with fast-evolving systems.

In the near term, it expects a shift towards genetic AI systems capable of carrying out real-world tasks, although growth may be constrained by energy and high-quality data shortages.

While this could deliver significant economic benefits, it remains unclear whether productivity gains from using AI will translate into broader growth.

UN Secretary-General Antonio Guterres urged governments to act swiftly. “The world cannot govern what it cannot understand,” Mr. Guterres said.

In the Strait of Hormuz, Iran firmly draws its red lines

NEWS ANALYSIS

Stanly Johnny

Forty days of war, more than 60 days of tense negotiations, and then a memorandum of understanding. Yet, the U.S. still has no easy solution to a problem that did not exist before it joined Israel in launching its war against Iran on February 28: who will manage the Strait of Hormuz?

The strait, a critical energy and economic chokepoint connecting the Persian Gulf with the Arabian Sea through the Gulf of Oman, was open to international shipping before the war. That changed within days of the U.S. attack, when Iran asserted control over the waterway. Since then, Washington has tried a range of measures to restore free navigation – it bombed Iran’s naval assets; U.S. President Donald Trump issued repeated ultimatums, threatening to destroy Iran’s critical infrastructure. When he announced a ceasefire on April 8, he declared that the strait would reopen.

In mid-April, he imposed a blockade on Iranian ports and later launched the short-lived Operation Project Free-

dom to protect commercial shipping transiting the strait. None of these measures persuaded Iran to restore free passage.

After the MoU was signed between the U.S. and Iran on June 17, Mr. Trump again said Hormuz would be fully reopened for toll-free shipping. Iran did open a new route for passage, along its coastline, which it said would be safe. But this did not resolve the crisis. Last week, an oil tanker off Oman’s coast was attacked by Iranian drones, after which the U.S. carried out attacks on Iran. Tehran retaliated, targeting U.S. bases in the region. While both sides agreed to halt tit-for-tat attacks, Iran has ruled out direct technical talks with the U.S., which were scheduled to continue this week, casting doubts on the implementation of the MoU.

At the heart of the problem lies a simple question: who controls the Strait of Hormuz?

What the MoU says

Under Article 5 of the MoU, Iran has promised to “make arrangements” for the “safe passage of commercial vessels, with no charges for 60 days only from the Persian Gulf to the Sea of Oman and vice



Vessels at the Strait, as seen from Musandam, Oman. REUTERS

versa”. It says commercial traffic would immediately start and Iran would remove mines and other technical impediments for traffic within 30 days of signing the memorandum. The next line of the article holds enormous significance for the future of the strait. It says Iran will conduct talks with Oman “to define the future administration and maritime services in the Strait of Hormuz, in discussions with other Persian Gulf littoral states, in line with applicable international law and the sovereign rights of coastal states”.

The agreement doesn’t say passage would be free of charges in the future – that provision is applicable for only 60 days. It says Iran – not the U.S. – will hold talks with its neighbours to define the future status of the strait. In other

words, Iran hasn’t given up its claims or control over the strait in the MoU. Rather, it has reasserted them.

The U.S., which has already lifted its maritime blockade, is not happy with leaving the levers of one of the world’s most important waterways in the hands of a state it sought to topple just four months ago. When U.S. Secretary of State Marco Rubio visited the region last week, he pressed Persian Gulf countries to push against the Iranian plan. Oman opened an alternative route, along its coast, to transit Hormuz. Soon after Mr. Rubio left, Iran attacked a Singapore-flagged tanker off Oman’s coast. Earlier, the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC) had warned that traffic through “non-designated routes” could be dangerous. Tehran knew

the attack risked escalating tensions with the U.S., but it appeared willing to take that risk rather than surrendering control of Hormuz. Mr. Trump called the drone attack a “foolish violation” of the ceasefire, and struck Iran, triggering a retaliatory response from Tehran.

Why Hormuz matters

From Iran’s point of view, two decisions it took proved critical to its own survival in the war – the regionalisation of the war by targeting American bases and energy infrastructure across the Persian Gulf, and the closure of the Strait of Hormuz. By retaining its grip on Hormuz despite American threats, attacks and blockade, Iran has demonstrated deterrence capability. Iran believes the war has fundamentally altered the region’s strategic landscape and that control over Hormuz is central to deterring future attacks. What it wants to do is to assert Iranian control and “sovereignty” over the strait—a game-changing move which could solidify Iran’s position as a powerful regional player in the Persian Gulf. Enforcing a service fee or insurance costs is only part of this broader objective.

Tehran wants vessels to use its designated route, coordinate with the newly created Persian Gulf Strait Authority (PGSA), and, eventually, pay for “services” provided by littoral states, drawing on models used in the Strait of Malacca and the Singapore Strait. “These are our territorial waters,” Iran’s Parliament Speaker and top negotiator with the U.S. said on June 30 in a televised interview. “Iran will never, under any circumstances, retreat from this position,” he added. Iranians want to institutionalise this new mechanism for long-term management of the strait. And Gulf countries, including Oman, Qatar, Saudi Arabia and even the UAE, are in talks with Tehran.

Mr. Trump still seems serious about negotiations with Iran. Despite Iran’s remarks that technical talks were called off over last week’s strikes, he sent Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner to Qatar. With mid-term elections looming and his approval ratings falling, Mr. Trump’s military options are constrained, at least for now. But he is also confronting a new reality in the Persian Gulf. The country he wanted to submit to U.S.-Israeli demands is now setting the terms of the regional order.

‘Ukraine hits Russian oil refinery’

Reuters
KYIV

Ukraine has struck a Russian oil refinery in the city of Ufa, more than 1,300 km from the frontline for the second time, President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said on Wednesday, as Kyiv steps up its strikes deep in Russia. “Every day, our plan

for imposing Ukrainian long-range sanctions is being implemented.” Mr. Zelenskyy said on X, referring to Ukrainian attacks deep inside Russian territory. “This is an entirely just response to everything Russia is doing against us.”

Mr. Zelenskyy also reported a strike on what he said was a “strategic” Rus-

sian military-industrial facility in the Penza region, involved in making components for missile weaponry used by Moscow in attacks on Ukraine.

Ukraine’s Defence Ministry said that its forces hit 11 oil refineries, as well as fuel logistics facilities, military factories, and other targets in June.

कार्यालय नगर परिषद, सीकर (राज०)
Add:- NEAR ABMEDKAR CIRCLE Sikar Pin 332001
Email:- sikarulb.jaipur@gmail.com

क्रमांक : 1734

ई-निविदा सूचना सं. 17/2026-27

दिनांक :- 24.06.2026

नगर परिषद सीकर द्वारा सिविल कार्यो हेतु सक्षम श्रेणी के पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों / फर्मों से व निविदा शर्तों अनुसार 6 कार्यो की ऑनलाईन निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। ऑनलाईन निविदा समाप्ति की तिथि 16.07.2026 को सायं 06:00 बजे तक तथा ऑनलाईन निविदा खोलने की तिथि 20.07.2026 प्रातः 10:00 बजे से है तथा निविदा पेटे इंप्रूवडी राशि का डिमान्ड ड्राफ्ट तथा निविदा में सम्मिलित किये गये संबंधित समस्त दस्तावेजों की हार्ड कॉपी जमा करवाने की दिनांक 17.07.2026 को प्रातः 10:00 बजे से सायं 5:00 बजे तक रहेगी।

निविदा संबंधी विवरण का अवलोकन नगर परिषद सीकर कार्यालय एवं नगर परिषद की वेबसाईट व कार्यो का विवरण www.spppraj.nic.in पर भी देखा जा सकता है एवं कार्यो की ऑनलाईन निविदा <http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in/> पर ही प्राप्त की जावेगी।

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वरिष्ठ आयुक्त

**GOVERNMENT OF INDIA-DEPARTMENT OF SPACE
CONSTRUCTION & MAINTENANCE GROUP, SDSC –SHAR
SRIHARIKOTA-524124**

Brief E-TENDER NOTICE

e-Tender Notice No.CMG/C/CON/268712_268713

Date: 30/06/2026

On behalf of President of India, Item Rate tenders are invited through e-tendering for the following works:

Sl. No.	Brief Name of work	Value (Rs)
1	Balance works for Package - D: Construction of LOSF storage bay for C32 main building, Chain link fencing, Deluge watershed, trenches, merlon stage pressurization room, Lpt for SLP Augmentation at SDSC SHAR.	167 Lakhs
2	Package D : Sub part : Construction of Effluent collection pit for LOFS SLP Augmentation at SDSC SHAR.	51 Lakhs

Last date for sale (Tender documents can be downloaded) up to 09/07/2026 14:30 hrs. For eligibility criteria and other details, interested tenderers may please refer to the detailed bilingual (Hindi-English) Notice Inviting Tenders (NIT) on the website <https://www.isro.gov.in/Tenders.html> and tender free view at <https://www.tenderwizard.com/isro>.

Sd/- GROUP HEAD, CMG/ SDSC SHAR

Mexican party continues after win over Ecuador at the Azteca



Hincapie gets sent off for covering mouth while talking to opponent



Koeman resigns as Netherlands coach after round-of-32 exit



Shreyas, Abhishek help India post 189 in first T20I against England



Kane magic helps England surmount DR Congo

INBRIEF



James decides to leave Lakers and play 24th NBA season

NBA superstar LeBron James will return for an unprecedented 24th season but not with the Los Angeles Lakers, a move that rocked the league on Tuesday as free agency opened. Four-time champion and Finals MVP James joined the Lakers in 2018 and led them to their 17th and most recent title in 2020. It was with the Lakers that he broke the league's all-time scoring record, and realised his long-cherished dream of playing alongside his son Bronny James.

Achutaditya-Arjun duo exits from Canada Open

The Indian men's doubles pair of D. Achutaditya Rao and P. Arjun suffered a first-round exit from the Canada Open badminton, losing 9-21, 7-21 to fifth-seeded home pair Kevin Lee and Ty Alexander Lindeman, in the opening round of BWF Super 300 event in Markham on Tuesday.

Zee gets the Bundesliga rights for India

Zee Entertainment Enterprises Ltd. has secured the exclusive broadcast and digital rights for the Bundesliga (German football league) in India for five years. Beginning with the 2026-27 season, Bundesliga matches will be available exclusively on Zee 5 and Unite8 Sports television channels. Viewers can watch comprehensive coverage of live matches, highlights, and exclusive shoulder programming.

Jacquet completes Liverpool move from Rennes

Liverpool has completed the signing of France U-21 centre-back Jeremy Jacquet from Rennes in a deal worth up to a reported £60 million. The Premier League side reached an agreement for the 20-year-old in January and he has now signed a five-year contract at Anfield with the option of a further 12 months, subject to international clearance. Meanwhile, Chelsea has signed Italy defender Marco Palestra from Atalanta with the 21-year-old signing a contract until 2033. Palestra was named Serie A Defender of the Year for the 2025-26 campaign.



Coimbatore, Tiruvallur emerge champions

Coimbatore beat Tiruvallur 2-1 in the final of the State senior men's inter-district team badminton event while Tiruvallur blanked Chengalpattu 2-0 in the women's final in Chennai.

The results (final): Men: Coimbatore bt Thiruvallur 2-1 (J.T. Sachin bt V. Tamilarasan 15-4, 15-11; T. Kishore Bathirappan & G. Poopesht lost to D. Nisanth & Santhosh 12-15, 13-15; Lokesh Viswanathan & P. Naveen bt Manigandan Rajasekaran & P. Vahin 15-10, 15-11). **Women:** Tiruvallur bt Chengalpattu 2-0 (S.R. Diksha bt Nakshatra Jairaj 15-10, 15-8; S. Deeta & K. Rubika bt Deepika Maria and M.P. Kaviska 15-1, 15-10).

State-level children's chess tournament on July 5

ARS Chess Academy will conduct its sixth State-level children's and Open tournament on July 5 at Shri Krishnaswamy College for Women, Anna Nagar. The categories are under-15, 13, 10 and 8 (boys and girls) and Open. Entries close on or before 10 p.m. on July 2. Entry fees can be paid through easypaychess.com/ chessfee.com/ bookmyfee.com/ chessentry.com. Call 99520 21133 for more details.

LIVE TELECAST

▼

Wimbledon: Star Sports 2, SS Select 1, 2 & JioHotstar, 3.30 p.m.

Women's T20 World Cup: Star Sports 1 & JioHotstar, 11 p.m.

FIFA World Cup: Unite8 Sports 1, 2 & Z5 App, 12.30 & 4.30 a.m. (Friday)

South Africa has its task cut out against England

Wolvaardt and Kapp need to bring their A-game; skipper Sciver-Brunt's return will bolster the home team while the in-form Wyatt-Hodge will look to continue her purple patch

T20 WORLD CUP

P.K. Ajith Kumar
LONDON

They have looked good, this England team. They have, in fact, looked good enough to pose a real challenge to Australia. Something nobody had has really managed to do at this T20 Women's World Cup. And it cannot get better much bigger than a final between the two bitter Ashes rivals at Lord's on Sunday. But, for the host there is this small matter of getting past South Africa in Thursday's semifinal at the Oval. And South Africa is one side that has caused problems for the English women at ICC events.

Key players True, the Proteas haven't been as dominating in their campaign as their rival, but their captain Laura Wolvaardt, who had hit a hundred and three half-centuries against India in a T20I series only a few months ago, is due for a big knock. And there is also that lion-hearted all-rounder Marizanne Kapp, who could influence a game, with both and ball, as she



Great expectations: South Africa will be eyeing a second straight T20 World Cup final. AP

showed against India in a crucial match in the Group of Death. Kapp forms part of a formidable South African pace attack spearheaded by Shabnim Ismail. **Powerful batting** But they will be up against a powerful England batting line-up, in which Danni Wyatt-Hodge has run into some ominous form, having notched up scores like 105 not out, 89 not out and 65. With 282 runs, at an average of 94 and strike-rate

of 153.26, she is the tournament's leading scorer by a mile. The return of skipper Nat Sciver-Brunt from injury - she hasn't played since retiring hurt during England's second match, against Ireland a fortnight ago - could make life even more difficult for the South African bowlers. England also has a sharp bowling attack, featuring some quality spinners. Sophie Ecclestone, Linsey Smith and Charlie Dean form a formidable

Today's match

Semifinal

England VS South Africa

The Oval, 11 P.M. IST

HEAD-TO-HEAD

Played: 28

England 23 South Africa 4 NR 1

LIVE ON STAR SPORTS 1 & JIOHOTSTAR

trio. And Lauren Bell ensures it is not just all about spin.

Abhinandh-Divyanshi duo in semifinals

Press Trust of India
BANGKOK

India's top-seeded U-19 mixed doubles pair of P.B. Abhinandh and Divyanshi Bhowmick moved into the semifinal after a sensational victory over their Chinese opponents at Asian Youth Table Tennis Championships on Wednesday. With the 11-9, 11-6, 11-7 quarterfinal win, the Indian pair not only secured a place in the last four but also assured the country of at least a bronze. **The results: Mixed doubles (quarterfinals):** P. B. Abhinandh & Divyanshi Bhowmick bt Yiren Tang and Yiyi Jiang (Chn) 11-9, 11-6, 11-7; Priyanju Bhattacharyya and Syndrela Das lost to Li Hechen & Yao Ruixuan (Chn) 7-11, 16-18, 7-11. **Pre-quarterfinals:** Abhinandh & Divyanshi bt Alvin Wong & Su Tsz Tung (Hkg) 11-6, 11-8, 11-9.

Aaron-Avanish: same pitch, shared dream

Anirudh Velamuri
HYDERABAD

Aaron George Varghese and Avanish Rao have spent the better part of their cricketing lives chasing the same dream on the same pitch. One scaled the summit, lifting the Under-19 World Cup in 2026. The other came within touching distance, finishing runner-up two years before that. They learnt to open the batting together in domestic cricket. Today, they walk out shoulder to shoulder once again, entrusted with setting the tone for Ranga Reddy Risers in the inaugural TG20. Both benefitted from the tutelage of Biju George before polishing their craft at Coaching Beyond. Every step of the ladder seemed to have room for the two as wherever one went, the other followed. Though their journeys



Aaron and Avanish... it takes two to tango. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

have been similar, their personalities are starkly different. Aaron lives in his own bubble: headphones on, eyes fixed and every thought focused on the next ball and the next innings. Avanish, on the other hand, has a bagful of cheer that can carry both of them. "His laugh is a little annoying. I don't think you've even heard him laugh properly. If you do, you'll get scared," Aaron tells *The Hindu*, unable to suppress a grin. It's a charge Avanish happily pleads guilty to. "I laugh in serious situations. It just comes out randomly and very loudly. A lot of people don't like it. I've tried so much to control it, but it's just not happening," he says, the familiar smile spreading across his face. Aaron has a favourite scoring shot for every format while Avanish's favourite changes almost every

What Sthalekar is up to these days: planning cricket tours

P.K. Ajith Kumar
LONDON

Lisa Sthalekar loves to wear different hats. She is here now with her newest. She has been a leading all-rounder with 3,913 runs and 229 wickets in international cricket. She has been a coach, administrator and commentator. But she is at the World Cup in a new capacity. The 46-year-old is a tour organiser and has brought in a group of cricket fans from around the world. The former Australia captain is the co-founder of *Around the Wicket*. "When I played in the 2005 World Cup in South Africa, my co-founder and a few friends and a couple of families came out, and it was really people that you recognised in the stands," Sthalekar told *The Hindu*. "I thought why wasn't there something for women's cricket?"

The first Her first major tour as a guide was to India for the Women's ODI World Cup last year. "Men can come as well, and we had 10 people, which included a man," said Sthalekar. "And we have got a lady from New Zealand who has never travelled much. I also have got someone from India who has never been to London." Talking about the World Cup, Sthalekar is impressed with Australia and England.



Lisa Sthalekar, former Australia captain. P.K. AJITH KUMAR

Australia is ticking all the boxes. England's top-order is firing... Lauren Bell has been bowling well and Linsey Smith, too

"Australia is ticking all the boxes," said the winner of two T20 World Cups. "England's top-order is firing... Lauren Bell has been bowling well and Linsey Smith, too. The real test will be when they lose some early wickets." Sthalekar has also been the mentor of UP Warriorz at the WPL. "My time with the UP Warriorz has been wonderful," she said. "I have enjoyed working with that group. They are really passionate about what they are trying to do. Unfortunately, things haven't quite clicked but I don't think we're that far away. Look out for the UP Warriorz come season five".

Santosh posts an upset win in Asia junior badminton

Press Trust of India
YATSUSHIRO (JAPAN)

India's Dhyan Santosh put up a clinical show to upset sixth seed Punnatat Prem-punpong of Thailand 21-17, 21-18 in the first round of Badminton Asia Junior Championships here on Wednesday. Tanvi Patri then breezed through her girls opening round, beating Indonesia's Christabel Purwanto 21-18, 21-6 while fifth seed Ruparelia defeated Sri Lanka's Pamudu Randiligama 21-13, 16-21, 21-7. Among the other Indian shuttlers in action, Adarshini Shri beat Lee Kay Xin of Malaysia 21-12, 21-12 but Abhinav Garg lost 13-21, 22-24 to Lucas Lee of Malaysia.

Chandrasekar spins Jolly Rovers to victory; SKM romps home

FIRST DIVISION

Sports Bureau
CHENNAI

D.T. Chandrasekar claimed six for 86 as Jolly Rovers bowled out Singam PulI for 170, while defending 224, on the final day of the fourth-round TNCA first division league match at the IITM-Chemplast ground on Wednesday. Earlier, M. Mathivanan picked up six for 81 to restrict Rovers to 214 after the latter had resumed the day at 174 for five, adding only 40 runs to its overnight total. **The scores (fourth round, third and final day): At Tagore College:** Young Stars 396 drew with Sea Hawks 219/9 in 130 overs (B. Sachin 45, R.S. Mokit Hariharan 64 n.o., Wilkins



Chandrasekar (Rovers, 6/86); Mathivanan (Singam PulI, 6/81).



Ganesh Moorthi (SKM, 6/21); Achyuth (MRC-A, 5/51).

Victor 4/101). **Points: Sea Hawks 2(13); Young Stars 2(10). At RKM-Vivekananda:** SKM 322 bt Globe Trotters 148 & 62 in 34.2 overs (M. Ganesh Moorthi 6/21, Rahil Shah 3/21). **SKM 6(8); Trotters 0(3). At IITM-Chemplast:** Jolly Rovers 186 & 214 in 79.2 overs (M.

Mathivanan 6/81, M. Siddharth 3/58) bt Singam PulI 176 & 170 in 60 overs (Ch. Jitendra Kumar 60, D.T. Chandrasekar 6/86). **Rovers 6(12); Singam PulI 0(7). At CSK-Guru Nanak:** Vijay 503/7 decl. drew with Grand Slam 369 in 125.3 overs (Abhinav Kannan 65, Aditya Venkatesh 55, Vignesh S. Iyer 77, M. Mohana Prasath 76, R. Bharat Srinivas 37 n.o., R. Sai Kishore 3/104). **Vijay 5(22); Grand Slam 1(13). At Nelson-Wahe Guru-A:** Pristine 325 & 168/3 decl. in 32 overs (K. Deeban Lingesh 68 n.o., V.S. Karthick Manikandan 39 n.o.) drew with Nelson 340 in 98.2 overs (Swapnil K. Singh 43, S. Rithik Easwaran 81, Robin Bist 88, Shoaib Mohd. Khan 32, Monish Satish 4/98). **Nelson 5(12); Pristine 1(8). At A.M. Jain:** Swaraj 187 & 173 in 82.2 overs (T. Vijay Abhimanyu 34, Siddarth Prakash 36, Himalaya 40, C.V. Achyuth 5/51, P. Vignesh 3/57) lost to MRC-A 368/8 decl. in 98.4 overs. **MRC-A 6(18); Swaraj 0(12).**

Thumping wins for Kancheepuram and Tiruvallur

Sports Bureau
CHENNAI

TIRUVALLUR: Kancheepuram and Tiruvallur cruised to victories in the Zone-A matches of the inter-district under-16 tournament on Wednesday. **The scores (first round): Zone-A (Tiruvallur):** Kanyakumari 42 in 22.3 overs (R. Sarvin Raj 3/13, S. Kiran Raj Yadav 3/12) lost to Tiruvallur 43/3 in 11 overs. Vellore 152/9 in 50 overs (K. Arjun Sai 31, K. Joshua Immanuel 30 n.o.) lost to Kancheepuram 153/2 in 35.5 overs (Ruthvik Muralidharan 62, G. Yogeshwar Rajan 62 n.o.). **Zone-H (Tiruvannamalai):** Dindigul 201 in 50 overs (S.P. Dhashwin 58, A.K. Sachin 39, B. Dhanush 3/21, B. Akshadh Rao 3/38) bt Chengalpattu 167 in 46.5 overs (B. Akshadh Rao 58, R. Rishi 37, S.N. Sri Hari 4/39, S.P. Dhashwin 3/31).

TNPL to be held in two venues from Aug. 4-28

Sports Bureau
CHENNAI

The 10th edition of the Tamil Nadu Premier League (TNPL) will be played from August 4 to 28 in Dindigul and Chennai. A total of 783 players have registered for the player auction, which will be held on July 3. Chennai's iconic MAC Stadium will host 12 matches, including the final. Last year, the TNPL was held across four venues — Coimbatore, Salem, Tirunelveli, and Dindigul (Natham).

This year, the first phase will be from August 4 to 15 at the NPR College ground in Natham before the action shifts to Chepauk from August 18 to 28. Chennai last hosted the TNPL in 2024, with Qualifier 2 and the summit clash being played at the venue. It is learnt that Sony will be the TV broadcast partner for the first time, while YouTube has won the streaming rights. The TNCA is also planning to hold two women's T20 exhibition games during the break days in Chennai.

ENGAGEMENTS

Cricket: TNCA inter-district u-16 tournament, first round, Group A, Kanyakumari vs Vellore (OCF, Avadi); Kancheepuram vs Ariyalur (Hindu-A), 9 a.m.; CIOC Cup, u-14 final, 22 Yards-KCG ground, Karapakkam, 8 a.m.

R. Kaushik

Anonymity is a very strange state of being, depending on which side of the fence one is on. Most of us go through life craving it, maybe because we aren't confident enough in ourselves, in our abilities and skills. Many of us willingly embrace it, because hey, isn't life easier that way? Some of us absolutely abhor it - who doesn't want to be known and recognised and celebrated and feted? And then there are the uber achievers, who enjoy the adulation and the attention but occasionally, very occasionally, covet it anonymity for the simple reason that being a celebrity doesn't allow them the 'luxury' of doing the simple, mundane, unglamorous everyday things.

Anonymity and Ben Stokes have never been intimate bedfellows. How could they be? Stokes isn't just a run-of-the-mill cricketer - he is not a right-arm trundler who relies on conditions to prise out the occasional wicket, he is not a left-handed plodder who nudges and nurdles and quietly moves to 30 or 40. He isn't a 'safe' fielder who is a bank when the ball comes directly to him but is otherwise inconspicuous on the park. He isn't hiding in the outfield, at fine-leg or third-man, trying to stay away from the 'action areas'. No sir, Ben Stokes is none of these things.

Never would Stokes have yearned for anonymity more than on that one dramatic April night in 2016, when the theatre of dreams which is the majestic Eden Gardens became his stage of nightmares. Oh wait, maybe that's not correct; Kolkata was potentially the first time in his international career that Stokes would have wished the spotlight were not trained on him, for all the wrong reasons.

For almost the entire length of England's T20 World Cup final against West Indies, Stokes had been a fringe entity, bordering on the anonymous. An unremarkable eight-ball 13 in his team's tally of 155 for nine, then modest figures of none for 17 from two overs as the Caribbeans got down to business. Until Eoin Morgan tossed him the ball for the final over of the tournament, with the game wide open, West Indies needing 19 to become the first two-time champions.

Marlon Samuels, the tempestuous but exceptionally gifted right-hander, had spearheaded a stuttering West Indian riposte with a glorious 85, but as Stokes marked his run-up, he was off strike, having failed to lay bat to Chris Jordan's last ball of the tournament. Instead, the towering figure of Carlos Brathwaite - 'Remember the name?', to quote Ian Bishop slightly out of context - stood nearly 40 yards away, deceptively lying in wait. Perhaps, the big right-hander would scamper a single and bring Samuels back on strike? After all, you'd back someone on 85 to knock off the remaining 18 off five deliveries, right?

Admiring spectator

Wrong. Brathwaite decided instead that he would flex his muscles. That Samuels, who had provided all the batting entertainment in the second half of the title clash, could now just be an admiring spectator, not the headline act. And so he went 6. Then 6. And 6 and 6 again. Four balls, four sixes, all over, thank you very much.

Eden Gardens erupted in ecstasy, matching the mood in the Caribbean camp which reflected on a glorious double. Just hours previously, West Indies Women had crowned themselves T20 World Cup champs for the first time, and watched proudly as their male counterparts too kept up their end of the bargain. The last of Brathwaite's four sixes was the spark for a party that didn't end for several hours.

As the Caribbeans swarmed Brathwaite and Samuels, Stokes cut a lonely figure. First hands on his knees, looking vacantly in front of him, then finding himself sucked in by the power of gravity, he would have so wished for the ground beneath him to cave him and gobble him up. His colleagues, with Morgan in the lead, swooped on him in consolation and commiseration, trying to convince him that defeat was collective, that Stokes mustn't be too harsh on himself. As if those words ever registered.

Could that passage of play could have 'broken' Stokes? Does the sun rise in the west? Is there no sand in the desert?

Prophetic words

When India were shot out for their lowest Test tally of 36 in Adelaide in late 2020, Ravi Shastri exhorted his wards to wear it 'like a badge on your sleeves'. "And you will be a great team," the head coach thundered.

Prophetic words, as India bounced back from that debilitating low to pull off one of the great miracles in modern-day cricket, clinching the series 2-1 despite key personnel dropping off like autumn leaves.

One isn't sure if, four and a half years previously, anyone had suggested the same to Stokes or whether he wore four sixes in the last over to lose a T20 World Cup final 'like a badge on his sleeve', but he did finish as a 'great' player. Great, in every sense of the term.

In this day of hyperbole and the need



History will regard Stokes as a great cricketer, with great being used in its purest and most unadulterated form. There are few sights in cricket of a recent vintage to match him on the field

to affix adjectives and superlatives as if there is no tomorrow, everything is 'great'. How many times have we watched even a T20 game on the telly and come away not having heard 'great' at all? A reverse sweep is great, a dot ball in the 19th over is great, a dramatic tumbling stop in the infield even though there is a fielder patrolling the boundary ropes is great. And that won't change, because apparently words like these are what keep the audience hooked when there are so many other avenues of entertainment available.

But even against this backdrop, but maybe more appropriately, independent of it, history will regard Stokes as a great cricketer. With great being used in its purest, most unadulterated form. A great cricketer, sure, but also a great competitor, a great motivator, a great entertainer. Great at making news too, for sure, but there are few sights in cricket of a recent vintage to match Ben Stokes on a cricket field.

Just the other day, Geoffrey Boycott, that wonderfully obdurate England opener whose cricket was as diametrically opposite to the Stokes brand as imaginable, wrote in his column in an English newspaper that while he considered Stokes the more dangerous bowler, in his estimation, Ian Botham was the greater all-rounder.

Boycott knows what he is saying - needless to mention; Botham was truly a fabulous showman who turned matches as much through his sheer magnetic presence as his bag of tricks that ranged from the innocuous to the outrageous. He would have been a perfect fit when it came to T20 cricket which, strangely enough, isn't Stokes' strongest suit. But who can argue that Stokes isn't at least in the same league as the older maverick who also had his fair share of misadventures off the park?

Any mention of Stokes going forward will always be accompanied by a footnote, an asterisk, recalling his off-field dalliances, one of which potentially pushed him into international retirement earlier this week.

Numerous controversies

Stokes has been involved in numerous controversies, most of them in or outside watering holes including a charge of affray in September 2017 of which he was cleared a year later.

It was his bending of a curfew last

month that was introduced to the English setup - Stokes himself was among those who framed the rules - which precipitated his premature departure from the sport at the highest level. Despite being 35, despite battling a ravaged and creaking and protesting body and despite having spent a decade and a half fashioning and pulling off miracles with stunning regularity, he still has so much cricket left in him.

The Stokes miracles are too many to be condensed into a few hundred words, though there are a couple that continue to astonish and exhilarate, nearly seven years after the acts and within a few weeks of each other.

The first of those came at the 50-over World Cup final at Lord's, against an indomitable New Zealand side led by one of the other stellar champions of modern times, Kane Williamson.

Chasing 242 for a maiden title - not even the magic of Botham had facilitated victory against Pakistan in the 1992 final at the gigantic MCG - England played themselves into a hole at 203 for six with only 23 deliveries remaining. But Stokes accounted for most of the next 38 runs as the match ended in a tie with Mark Wood run out off the last ball in looking for the winning run.

Sensational tie

Stokes finished unbeaten on a marvellous 84 as the match ended in a sensational tie. He then swiped eight off three in the Super Over, which too ended indecisively, but England were declared triumphant on the quirky boundary countback rule that has since been banished into oblivion.

The events of July 14, which helped England finally break their 50-over World Cup duck and slay the ghosts of 2015, when they failed to advance beyond the first stage, propelled the legend of Stokes to stratospheric proportions. Already a hero of the masses, he won over tight upper-lipped too; Lord's went nuts (really, no exaggeration) and Stokes became a national hero, having fashioned the impossible.

Mere mortals would find it impossible to top those heroics, but Stokes hasn't always conformed to norm. And so there he was, a month later, pulling off another otherworldly rabbit out of the hat, in a

Test match but not in just any Test match foe, the one who must not win. But it was old foe that led 1-0, with three to play, when England and Australia lined up at Headingley for the middle fixture of what unspooled into one of the great Ashes showdowns.

Australia were well on course to establish an unbeatable 2-0 lead after setting the hosts a target of 359. The highest total in the first three innings was 246, England had been shot out for 67 in their first dig. How do you even think of making more than five times that many, in the final innings?

How do you, Ben? England were 286 for nine when Jack Leach, the uncelebrated No. 11, joined Stokes.

Incredible climax

In a fairytale passage lasting 62 deliveries of which Leach faced only 17, Stokes cut loose with an unbeaten 135 that hauled his team over past the winning post. Stokes for PM in the summer of 2019? Well, England would certainly not have had four Prime Ministers in the last seven years.

THE GIST

Never would Stokes have yearned for anonymity more than on that one dramatic April night in 2016, when the theatre of dreams which is the majestic Eden Gardens became his stage of nightmares

He gave hope, owned some of the greatest moments in the sport but has been controversy's favourite child too and robbed us of a career that had a lot more to offer

The Stokes miracles are too many to be condensed into a few hundred words, though there are a couple that continue to astonish and exhilarate, nearly seven years after the acts and within a few weeks of each other



Survival of the wittiest? Scientists debate if wit helped evolve language

By identifying 'living fossils' in modern human speech, some researchers are arguing that language evolved the way life evolved; the theory suggests verbal humour was sexually selected over physical fighting, using visual brain regions to build the foundation of complex grammar

Rohini Subrahmanyam
BENGALURU

Language is a key aspect of human life that most likely came up more than a lakh years ago – but linguists still disagree on how exactly it evolved. The influential U.S. linguist and philosopher Noam Chomsky proposed that complex modern language emerged suddenly, a theory that many linguists still stick to. But some believe the languages we speak today, with all the complex grammatical rules nestled within them, must have evolved gradually, the way our cognitive abilities evolved.

Ljiljana Progovac, a linguist in Wayne State University in the U.S., is one of the latter. In a recent study, she argued that humans' ability to be witty with their words could have been sexually selected for, in a similar way peahens select peacocks with a brighter plumage. She said she believes the idea of "survival of the wittiest" needs to be added to the complex picture of human evolution.

Using syntactic theory, which says sentences have an inherent hierarchical structure to them, she reconstructed what she believes is the earliest stage of grammar: a combination of two words at a time, a verb and a noun (such as "eat food" or "seek truth"). Syntax – the rules that dictate how words and phrases should be used together to form meaningful sentences, grammar, and language – must have evolved gradually from these simple verb-noun compounds, she said.

"By deconstructing language evolution and coming up with the first stage, you can actually see why the next stage would evolve, because [the first stage] already provides a foundation."

'Living fossils of language'

She then realised many modern languages also have such verb-noun compounds, like "pickpocket", "killjoy", "crybaby", and "scatterbrain" in English.

"So then, because they resemble the stage that I reconstructed, I called them fossils, living fossils of language," Dr. Progovac said. "Because they show properties that I predicted the earliest stages had to have."

Some believe language does not leave behind fossils as evidence, but Dr. Progovac's findings challenge that notion.

"And sure, we are not going to find language in the stones," she said. "But these are even better fossils, because in a way, language never died. It just kept building and living in different generations."

According to her, these verb noun compounds mostly seemed to describe humans in a funny, typically negative way – like witty banter.

Previous neuroimaging studies have shown that women are very responsive to humour in men. Men, on the other hand, are less responsive to women being funny. Another study that analysed classified ads for partners and later followed up with the men and women who posted the ads showed that men seemed to prefer women who laughed at the jokes they cracked.

These studies suggest a type of sexual dimorphism in humans, Dr. Progovac said. Thus, this ability to combine words in a humorous way – which may have existed during the earliest stages of language – could have been sexually selected for during the course of evolution, according to her.

"From the very beginning of language, if it started something like this, there was selection for the genetic makeup of those individuals who were just a little better at this game," she continued. "They would have been more noticed, they would have left more offspring and generation after generation, this would have helped evolve language further and further."

Wit over fights

Her other argument is that humans who evolved to be quick-witted and to 'fight' with words rather than physically could have adapted better.

"Human beings are, to a large extent, characterised by their preference for cognitive contests, for competing with words, and not with physical fighting," she said.

Another hint that these verb-noun compounds could have been involved in sexual selection is that there are many more of them than one would expect, or even need, in a language.

In her analysis, Dr. Progovac found that hundreds of such words have existed in the English language in the past but have slowly fallen out of use. In the mediaeval times, there may as well have been thousands of such words in use. This is



A group of people enjoys stand-up comedy. Based on her findings, Ljiljana Progovac said she believes the emergence of very simple grammar, like combining just a verb and a noun to give rise to many playful words to describe others in a funny way, could have played a role in human evolution. FILE PHOTO

somewhat analogous to the peacock's feathers being more extravagant than they probably need to be to catch a female's attention.

Dr. Progovac is also particularly intrigued by these linguistic "living fossils" because they can now help test hypotheses. Using neuroimaging experiments, she decided to test how different regions of people's brains react when they hear these syntactically simple verb-noun compounds like 'killjoy' or 'pickpocket', versus the more complex "-er" ending words like "joy killer" or "pocket picker".

She found that a brain region called the fusiform gyrus – which evolved earlier in mammalian brains than the regions involved in processing language – was more active when people heard the verb-noun compounds versus the "-er" ending words. This region is also responsible for visual processing and is thought to help the brain process imageability and metaphors – which, by their nature, are very visually descriptive.

The words they used, like "scatterbrain" or "rattlesnake", are also very visual: they "paint a picture that is more abstract," Dr. Progovac said. "Like when we say 'scatterbrain', we do not mean literally scattering somebody's brain. But [that that] somebody is absent-minded." Because these words were more visual and grammatically more simple, she realised they were being processed by the visual area of the brain, "which is certainly much more ancient than any language areas of the brain," Dr. Progovac said.

A tendency to be abstract

Based on her findings, Dr. Progovac said she believes the emergence of very simple grammar, like combining just a verb and a noun to give rise to many playful words to describe others in a funny or derogatory way, could have played a major role in human evolution.

"Quick wittedness and wittiness, more generally humour, was a very important aspect of human cognitive evolution," she said.

Prof. Chomsky also believes the primary driver for the emergence of language may have been the need to construct and organise internal thoughts, rather than communicate outwardly. One reason for this is that language has a

The findings by Dr. Progovac of the Wayne State University in the U.S. challenge the notion put forward by the likes of Noam Chomsky, suggesting that language evolved gradually for people to communicate better – or, more specifically, to communicate in an entertaining way

tendency to be abstract and ambiguous rather than crystal clear at all times.

But Dr. Progovac's findings challenge that notion, suggesting that language evolved gradually for people to communicate better – or, more specifically, to communicate in an entertaining way.

Kenny Smith, a linguist at the University of Edinburgh, said he agrees that humans do not just use language in a dry "information transfer" fashion. Finding new, witty ways to express oneself could have helped in driving linguistic creativity and metaphors, in turn acting as an engine for language to change as well.

"Historical linguistics literature is full of examples of language change that seem to be driven by people trying to express the same old kinds of concepts in new entertaining ways," he said.

'Revival of the wittiest'

But even though he broadly agreed with the functional importance of linguistic creativity, he is less confident about inferring the earliest stage of language from that perspective.

"I think it is good to think about additional payoffs you can get from combining words, and one of them is you can start combining words in kind of surprising metaphorical ways," he said. "That does not necessarily mean that the very earliest stages of language evolution were two-word combinations that were [created] with *that* goal in mind" (emphasis in the original).

"It is hard to fit an evolutionary history from a potential function," he added.

Dr. Smith is also sceptical that sexual selection could necessarily have led to a "survival of the wittiest".

"I do not know why it [is] not about trying to make people in general like you,

rather than specifically like members of the opposite sex. My observation from hanging out with my male friends is that they are constantly trying to make each other laugh," he said. "It is not because they are competing [or] trying to attract people. It is just because they want their friends to like them. They want to be funny. If you are able to express yourself in an entertaining way, people will want to collaborate with you, hang out with you, work with you, not fight with you. And that is a payoff regardless of whether that is a potential sexual partner or not."

Both men and women are also equally capable of being witty, so the idea of sexual dimorphism does not map well onto human language, Dr. Smith explained – the same way that it would in songbirds.

"It does not really match with how the world looks in societies where men and women both have a more equal role."

Sexism in society

He also said he thinks any differences we see in sexually selective behaviour says more about sexism in society rather than differences in language abilities specifically.

"It is really hard to separate it from just a broader society where males and females are expected to have these different stereotypical roles they are supposed to take on," he said.

The idea of pressures that could have favoured creativity – that could have, over longer timescales, selected for individuals who are good at expressing themselves in new, entertaining ways – is interesting to think about, Dr. Smith acknowledged. But it would be challenging to identify if the selection is specific to linguistic creativity or if it is for broadly creative individuals who also happen to have a way with words.

"Not just for language, [but] how you extract resources from the world or how you interact with other people, being quick on your feet mentally probably pays off in a wide number of domains," he said. "And so maybe wittiness in language is just a reflection of that general selection for being innovative, creative, adaptable. It is hard to imagine circumstances where that's not an advantage."

(Rohini Subrahmanyam is a freelance journalist in Bengaluru. roh.subb@gmail.com)



A study has found that the risk of a batter getting out was higher when part of a left-right pairing than for a same-handed partnership. REUTERS

Common cricket strategy may be a myth, data analysis finds

Vasudevan Mukunth

In cricket, few strategies are as deeply ingrained as the left-right batting combination: where of the two batters at the crease, one is left-handed and other right-handed. Coaches, commentators, and even players have argued that every time the batters switch ends when they run, the bowler and captain have to adjust their tactics and field placements. The wisdom is that this constant change will disrupt the bowler's rhythm and allow for more runs. However, a new working paper by economists Johan Fourie and Krige Siebrits, of Stellenbosch University in South Africa, has concluded that this wisdom might be a myth.

"This paper provides the first rigorously controlled test of cricket's conventional wisdom that left-right batting partnerships provide a scoring advantage," they wrote. The duo analysed a database of 96,686 partnerships and 34 lakh deliveries across men's international cricket – including Tests, ODIs, and T20Is – from 2001 and 2025. And they found that the left-right combination conferred no advantage.

Fourie wrote on his blog that India coach Gautam Gambhir and assistant coach Ryan ten Doeschate, as well as former South Africa captain Graeme Smith and his batting partner Herschelle Gibbs are strong supporters of the idea.

Instead, he and Siebrits found that the wisdom could have persisted because left-handed batters have been, on average, better than right-handed ones even though the latter are more common. Specifically, they reported that mixed-hand partnerships could have seemed more productive because they included very talented left-handed batters rather than because the batters disrupted the rhythm of elite bowlers. They found this because once they controlled for the individual quality of the batsmen and for the match conditions, the putative advantage of the left-right combination vanished from the data.

Their study also took a closer look at ball-by-ball data to check whether a bowler is more likely to bowl a bad ball immediately after the batters have changed ends. According to their analysis, bowlers' performance did drop slightly after the batsmen had switched ends – however, this did not depend on the batter's handedness. Put differently, bowlers would have been equally disrupted by two right-handed batters changing strike.

Finally, the analysis uncovered a potential disadvantage of sticking with a left-right combination. The duo found that the risk of a batter being dismissed was actually higher when part of a mixed-hand partnership than for a same-handed partnership. In other words, the left-right tactic could be counterproductive because it forces a batsman to play in a position where they may be less comfortable. But the wisdom wasn't entirely wrong, at least according to the analysis: the duo found a small exception in T20I matches. While the average benefit of the combination was still zero, mixed-hand partnerships in T20Is occasionally provided a small boost in the middle of the team's batting innings. This, the authors figured, could be because of the highly tactical nature of this format, which incentivises match-ups against specific types of bowlers together with rules that favour batting. But overall, Fourie and Siebrits concluded, the only wisdom that the data supported was that a team's composition should be based on skills alone rather than include the batter's handedness as well.

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Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Growth in India's power consumption in June

11.62 in per cent. India's power consumption grew to 166.46 billion units (BU) in June compared to the same month last year due to heat wave conditions and the late onset of monsoon across the country, which pushed usage of cooling appliances. PTI

Number of entities SEBI has banned for six years

221 Markets regulator SEBI has barred 221 entities, including individual investor Hanif Shekh, from the securities market for up to seven years and levied a fine of ₹10 crore for orchestrating a large-scale pump-and-dump operation in five stocks between 2017 and 2020. PTI

Number of people in Sudan who died from cholera outbreak

120 A cholera outbreak in Sudan has killed 120 people, the World Health Organization said on Wednesday. More than three years of war between Sudan's army and the paramilitary Rapid Support Forces (RSF) have decimated the country's healthcare system. AFP

UN's estimate of how much Ebola outbreak could cost Africa

3.6 in \$ billion. The Ebola outbreak in the DR Congo threatens tens of thousands of jobs and could cost Africa up to \$3.6 billion, the United Nations said. It said the epidemic was "sparking a far-reaching socioeconomic crisis which could push 985,000 more people into poverty". AFP

Amount ordered by Swedish court for Google to pay

1.46 in \$ billion. A Swedish market court on Wednesday ordered Google to pay some 14.3 billion kronor in damages to price comparison site PriceRunner for promoting its own shopping comparisons in search results. AFP
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What is the TET paper leak case?

Why was the Maharashtra Teacher Eligibility Test postponed? Who is the key accused in the alleged paper leak case? How did police uncover the alleged paper leak? Why do investigators suspect an inter-State racket? What has the investigation revealed so far?

EXPLAINER

Vinaya Deshpande Pandit

The story so far:

The Special Investigation Team (SIT) is probing an inter-State paper leak racket after the Maharashtra Teacher Eligibility Test (TET) was postponed following an alleged leak. Investigators suspect the accused have links to similar paper leak cases in other States.

What is Maharashtra TET?

The Maharashtra Teacher Eligibility Test is an examination that assesses candidates' proficiency in subjects such as mathematics, science and languages for teaching roles. It is mandatory under the Right to Education Act to recruit primary school teachers for Classes I to VIII. As per guidelines issued by the National Council for Teacher Education, each State conducts its own

In Maharashtra, the examination is conducted by the Maharashtra State Council of Examination (MSCE), headquartered in Pune.

Why was the examination postponed?

The examination was scheduled for June 28. However, on the eve of the examination, the Maharashtra State Council of Examination postponed it after a police probe found that the papers had allegedly been leaked.

The last-minute postponement has affected more than six lakh candidates.

What is the paper leak scam?

Acting on a tip-off, the Thane Police laid a trap last week and arrested three accused who were allegedly trying to sell examination papers for ₹1.5 crore. Police had received information that a group of men was attempting to sell papers across Mumbai, Thane, Pune, Solapur, Nagpur, and Indore.

According to police, two separate groups of men from Bihar and Haryana reached Bhiwandi during the last weekend of June to allegedly sell four TET papers, apparently unaware of each other



Thane Police apprehends three individuals in connection with the alleged Maharashtra Teacher Eligibility Test question paper leak, in Bhiwandi, on June 27. ANI

but believed to be operating under the same kingpin situated in Bihar. They allegedly planned to target coaching classes and sell the papers for ₹1.5 crore, with individual candidates being charged around ₹1.5 lakh each.

During the investigation, police used a decoy to pose as a buyer. The accused allegedly showed the question paper during a video call and then negotiated its sale.

After verifying the authenticity of the seized material, police arrested three individuals: Rajeev Shriprayag Shaw (Bihar), Akash Kumar Swaraj Kumar (Bihar), and Dheeraj Balraj Singh (Haryana). One of Dheeraj's associates, Kapil Dahiya (Haryana), reportedly managed to escape and remains absconding.

How many people have been booked so far?

A first information report (FIR) has been registered by the Thane Police against six persons so far. Four of them have been arrested. A Look Out Circular (LOC) has been issued against the two absconding accused.

Investigators have identified one of the absconding accused, Bijendar Kumar Baleshwar Kumar Sah, a resident of Patna, Bihar, as the alleged mastermind of the scam. Maharashtra Police also arrested his wife, Suman Kumari Gupta, from Patna.

Police are probing the accused's links to similar scams in other States. Officials investigating the case said Bijendar Kumar was allegedly involved in a 2024 Odisha paper leak scam. They also suspect his

involvement in other paper leak cases, including the NEET scam, a senior officer said.

Why do the police suspect a larger network?

Police suspect a larger network because of the way the Maharashtra TET question papers were handled and distributed. The question papers are printed in Agra, where police say papers for other examinations are also printed. Investigators are examining possible locations of the paper leak and the likelihood of a nexus between different groups.

According to the investigation, the MSCE has signed a contract with Mahim Patram Private Limited, a company based in Agra and registered in Delhi, to print the TET papers. Police said the company has been handling similar contracts for the past 60 years.

As per procedure, MSCE hands over sealed question papers to the company about two months before the examination. These papers are then printed under security protocols and transported to examination centres.

Police are investigating the possibility of a leak at any stage in this process, which spans over two months. "After handing over the sealed papers, MSCE or Maharashtra Education Department officials are not present during printing or the tracking of the papers," police said.

Police teams are also probing the possibility of a leak during the transport of sealed papers to the examination centres. In the current case, the recovered papers carry serial numbers from the Latur, Jalna, and Washim centres. Each centre has a different serial number. This is a security measure put in place to help identify the source of a leak, if one occurs.

So far, 10 different teams have been formed by the SIT probing the case. These teams have travelled to four States, including Haryana, Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, and Delhi. Some teams have also visited Latur, Jalna, and Washim in Maharashtra.

The Maharashtra government is considering invoking the stringent provisions of the Maharashtra Control of Organised Crime Act against the accused.

THE GIST

The Maharashtra TET was postponed after police uncovered an alleged question paper leak, leading to the arrest of three accused and an SIT probe into an interstate paper-leak racket.

Investigators suspect the leak is linked to a larger network with possible connections to paper leak cases in other States, and are probing every stage of the printing and distribution process to trace its source.

Why has the govt. notified a new set of telecom rules?

How do the rules change the telecom regulatory framework? What powers does the Act give the govt.?

Aroon Deep

The story so far:

The Telecommunications Act, 2023, saw a clutch of rules being notified this month, namely the Telecommunications (Authorisation for Provision of Principal Telecommunication Services) Rules, 2026; the Telecommunications (Authorisation for Captive Telecommunication Services) Rules, 2026; and the Telecommunications (Authorisation for Provision of Miscellaneous Telecommunication Services) Rules, 2026.

What changes for telecom operators and users?

There are not many operational changes in India's telecom ecosystem due to the parent act or the rules being notified, as

the major objective of the legislation is to simplify the oft-amended Indian Telegraph Act, 1885, which it replaces (along with other accompanying laws, like the Wireless Telegraphy Act, 1933).

Along the way, the Union government got some greater powers in the text of the parent statute, such as a definition of "telecommunication" that can be used to regulate messaging apps. (While the government initially denied this, last year the Department of Telecommunications (DoT) tried to force WhatsApp to log out users every six hours from web instances of the service, and to "bind" every user to a SIM, as an anti-spam measure.)

Which provisions of the Act have already been brought into force?

This is, of course, not the beginning of the notification of the Act. As early as 2024, the government notified parts of the law,

such as one that renamed the Universal Service Obligation Fund (where telcos are required to pay into a corpus to fund financially unfeasible telecom infrastructure in remote and isolated areas) to the Digital Bharat Nidhi. Another part of the law that was notified was one that allowed the government to seize telecom infrastructure on national security or war grounds.

More parts of the law that have already been notified in previous months include a replacement for the interception orders, where in spite of an industry and civil society push, the government retained senior officials' powers to issue phone and internet tapping orders.

The specific rules notified this month replace the bulk of the licensing framework for telecom operators. This has been replaced with the term "authorisation," accompanied by

language that simplifies and modifies some of the paperwork that telcos and Internet Service Providers (ISPs) have to do. It also adds anti-spam enforcement as an obligation under the Parent Act.

Why are some aspects of the new regime still uncertain?

The new telecom act also recognises satellite internet, but this has been taken away, even as Starlink, the largest satellite internet provider in the world, awaits approvals to launch. "The final Rules have removed explicit references to Global Mobile Personal Communications by Satellite (GMPCS), as contained in the Draft Rules," the law firm Khaitan & Co wrote in a brief. Separately, news reports (and the delay) indicate that the government is yet to give up on concerns of whether it can truly shut off Starlink, seeing how it is used in countries like Iran in defiance of the local government.

At any rate, telcos and ISPs can choose to migrate to this authorisation regime now, or wait until their licenses expire and then apply afresh. As Khaitan & Co pointed out, "a significant volume of operational detail is still awaited ... implementation detail awaits further clarity and remains dependent on further specifications, including the 'sound' track-record criterion, exemption thresholds and technical directions."

THE GIST

The newly notified rules largely replace the old telecom licensing framework with an authorisation regime, simplify compliance for telecom operators and ISPs, and add anti-spam obligations, while leaving day-to-day operations largely unchanged.

Although several provisions of the Telecommunications Act have already been brought into force, implementation is still incomplete, with satellite internet rules, Starlink approvals, and key operational details yet to be clarified.

